

SCOPE / SCHEDULES / DECISIONS / DELIVERY

Project Management English

Make the dependency visible. Make the decision clear.

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Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For project managers, coordinators, delivery leads, sponsors, and project-office teams.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight delivery conversations that turn requests, dates, risks, and progress claims into precise project communication.

01 Project Charter and Scope Definition

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A dashboard is not yet a defined project | Clarify the users, decisions, boundaries, and acceptance basis behind a sponsor request before treating a target date as a commitment.

02 Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies

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Just one more report before launch | Respond constructively to a late scope request by comparing explicit options, effort, schedule effects, and approval status.

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Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened | Produce a concise executive update that shows material threats, rating criteria, and decision needs without confusing task counts with delivery confidence.

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Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted | Resolve a delivery-status disagreement by linking agreed criteria to evidence, distinguishing missing proof from failure, and naming the acceptance authority.

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Turn communication was poor into a testable action | Convert a vague lesson into a specific process change with an owner, deadline, adoption check, and separate effectiveness review.

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A useful update enables a decision.

Project conversations compress complicated situations into short phrases: nearly done, approved in principle, on track, or just one more feature. Each can hide a different uncertainty. These cases develop the language for unpacking the claim, identifying the consequence, and making the next decision explicit without burying the listener in a task-by-task history.

Give each claim a reference point

A delay needs a baseline and a calendar. Completion needs acceptance evidence. A color rating needs defined criteria. State the basis before expecting another person to act on the label.

"Testing is forecast three working days behind the approved schedule."

Separate an option from authorization

A useful proposal can still be unapproved. Say who recommends it, who can decide, what changes, and when a decision is needed. Do not turn meeting enthusiasm into permission.

"The group recommends deferring the feature; approval is still required."

Distinguish present problems from uncertainty

A confirmed missed commitment is an issue to manage now. Its full consequences may remain uncertain. Keep both the present fact and the future exposure visible.

"The supplier has confirmed the miss; the replacement delivery date is still unknown."

Close the communication loop

Name the action, owner, deadline, and evidence needed to close it. A sent message, a scheduled review, or a vendor completion claim is not proof that the receiving team accepted the result.

"Two acceptance criteria still lack evidence; please confirm their review owner."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

Original fictional language practice, not a project-management certification, contract interpretation, engineering instruction, or release authorization. All organizations, dates, numbers, and decisions are invented. Actual work must follow the governing agreement, approved project controls, applicable rules, and responsible decision makers.

A dashboard is not yet a defined project

A Read the situation

Clarify the users, decisions, boundaries, and acceptance basis behind a sponsor request before treating a target date as a commitment.

Sponsor Greg requests a dashboard in four weeks, but the initial brief does not identify users, decisions, or exclusions. In a planning meeting with project manager Elena, he proposes a first release for operations leads doing weekly queue triage: overdue-item visibility and an export. Automated work allocation would be excluded. Data access and acceptance criteria remain unconfirmed, and no scope baseline is approved. Elena must turn the request into a reviewable definition without promising the four-week target.

PEOPLE / Greg: Project sponsor | Elena: Project manager

CLARIFICATION PROTECTS THE INTENDED VALUE

A sponsor may name a solution before describing the decision it should support. Ask what people will do with the result and what belongs outside the first release. The questions make the request actionable; they do not require the sponsor to design every technical detail.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Who are the proposed first-release users?

- A** Only the finance audit committee
- B** Unspecified public visitors
- C** Operations leads doing weekly queue triage
- D** Every external customer

2. Which feature is proposed as excluded?

- A** Automated work allocation
- B** Overdue-item visibility
- C** An export
- D** Access to the proposed first-release view

3. What does four weeks represent now?

- A** An approved baseline with all dependencies confirmed
- B** A requested target, not a supported delivery commitment
- C** A completed acceptance decision
- D** Proof that data access is available

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

project charter

A document formally establishing a project and its high-level authority and purpose.

IN USE approve the project charter

project sponsor

The person accountable for sponsorship and relevant business decisions.

IN USE confirm the project sponsor

business need

The problem or opportunity the work is intended to address.

IN USE clarify the business need

business case

The justification for the proposed investment and expected value.

IN USE review the business case

project objective

A specific result the project is intended to achieve.

IN USE define the project objective

deliverable

A defined output to be produced by the project.

IN USE identify the deliverable

outcome

A change or result enabled by using the project's outputs.

IN USE distinguish outputs from outcomes

benefit

A measurable improvement of value from the change.

IN USE define the expected benefit

scope statement

A description of the work and boundaries included in the project.

IN USE refine the scope statement

scope baseline

The approved scope reference used to manage and assess changes.

IN USE establish the scope baseline

in scope

Included within the defined project boundary.

IN USE confirm what is in scope

out of scope

Excluded from the defined project boundary.

IN USE state what is out of scope

Precision check

A dashboard is an output; improved queue decisions would be an intended outcome. The proposed users and exclusions narrow the request, but they do not confirm access, acceptance, or schedule feasibility. Four weeks remains a target until supported and authorized.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

assumption

A premise used for planning that needs appropriate validation or monitoring.

IN USE record a planning assumption

constraint

A limit within which the project must operate.

IN USE identify a constraint

requirement

A defined need or condition the solution must satisfy.

IN USE clarify the requirement

acceptance criterion

A condition used to decide whether an output is acceptable.

IN USE define acceptance criteria

stakeholder

A person or group affected by or able to affect the project.

IN USE identify key stakeholders

end user

A person who will use the delivered capability.

IN USE consult the end user

decision use

The decision or action a delivered information product supports.

IN USE clarify the decision use

work breakdown structure

A hierarchical division of project work into manageable components, abbreviated WBS.

IN USE develop the work breakdown structure

work package

A defined unit of work that can be assigned and managed.

IN USE specify a work package

requirements traceability

Links connecting needs, requirements, work, and evidence.

IN USE maintain requirements traceability

success measure

A defined indicator used to assess the intended result.

IN USE agree a success measure

scope approval

Authorization of the stated project boundaries and work.

IN USE obtain scope approval

Precision check

An export and automated allocation are different capabilities. Listing one does not silently include the other. Acceptance needs a checkable basis, including who accepts the result; a demonstration that looks useful is not automatically formal approval.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE NEED

"Which decision should the dashboard help users make?"

ANCHOR THE TASK

"They will use it for weekly queue triage."

STATE THE EXCLUSION

"Automated allocation is outside the proposed first release."

QUALIFY THE DATE

"Four weeks is the requested target, not yet a delivery commitment."

NAME THE AUDIENCE

"The proposed first users are operations leads."

DEFINE THE OUTPUT

"The first release would show overdue items and provide an export."

SEPARATE VALUE FROM OUTPUT

"A delivered screen is not itself evidence of better queue decisions."

IDENTIFY A DEPENDENCY

"We still need to confirm access to the source data."

Dashboard

Names a product form, not its full purpose or scope.

Need

Distinguish the business problem from a preferred implementation.

Target

An intended date, not automatically an authorized commitment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASK FOR ACCEPTANCE

"What evidence will show that the first release meets the agreed need?"

KEEP ASSUMPTIONS VISIBLE

"Record the data-access assumption until it is verified."

DEFINE A MEASURABLE CHECK

"Replace looks good with a checkable acceptance condition."

CONNECT THE RECORDS

"Link the requirements to the scope and acceptance evidence."

NAME THE APPROVER

"Who is authorized to accept the defined output?"

AVOID IMPLIED ADDITIONS

"A useful future feature is not automatically part of this release."

PRESERVE THE PROPOSAL

"These are proposed boundaries pending review."

CLOSE THE DEFINITION

"Confirm users, decision use, inclusions, exclusions, and approval route."

First release

Requires explicit limits rather than an implied complete solution.

Accepted

Needs the relevant criteria and decision authority.

Useful

A value judgment that still needs a stated user and task.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which scope statement best matches the supplied proposal?

- A** A complete automated allocation platform for all customers
- B** Any feature suggested during development
- C** A screen with no identified user or decision
- D** Overdue-item visibility and export for weekly operations triage, excluding automated allocation

2. What can Elena responsibly say about four weeks?

- A** It is guaranteed because the sponsor requested it.
- B** It is already an achieved delivery date.
- C** It means every proposed future feature is included.
- D** It is the target; access, acceptance, and feasibility still need confirmation.

3. Which is an outcome rather than merely an output?

- A** An export button exists.
- B** A project charter is stored.
- C** Operations leads make better-supported queue-priority decisions.
- D** A dashboard file is delivered.

4. Why define who accepts the work?

- A** The vendor can decide every customer's obligations alone.
- B** A useful demonstration does not identify authorized acceptance by itself.
- C** Any observer's applause automatically approves the baseline.
- D** Acceptance is unrelated to the agreed requirements.

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

A dashboard is not yet a defined project

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

acceptance criterion / requirements traceability / out of scope / assumption / scope statement / business need / end user / deliverable / constraint / scope approval

- 01 **Greg:** I would like the dashboard in four weeks. The request is short because I thought the team would know what a useful operations dashboard should contain.
- 02 **Elena:** We need to clarify the ¹ _____. Which decision should it support, and who will use it? Those answers help us define the first release rather than guess.
- 03 **Greg:** Operations leads would use it for weekly queue triage. They need to see overdue items and take an export into the planning discussion.
- 04 **Elena:** That gives us a specific ² _____ and task. It is more actionable than a dashboard for everyone, because we can connect the requirements to a real workflow.
- 05 **Greg:** I do not need automated work allocation in the first version. That might become useful later, but visibility and an export are the immediate request.
- 06 **Elena:** I will make that ³ _____ for the proposed first release. A possible future capability should not quietly enter the current delivery commitment.
- 07 **Greg:** Is the dashboard itself the objective, or should we describe what changes once the team uses it? I want the project to do more than add another screen.
- 08 **Elena:** Distinguish the ⁴ _____ from the intended outcome. We can deliver a working view, but better queue decisions require the right information and actual use by the leads.
- 09 **Greg:** We should probably define what shows that the view is adequate. Otherwise I might approve a demonstration and discover later that it cannot support the weekly meeting.
- 10 **Elena:** We need an ⁵ _____ for each relevant requirement. We also need to identify who can accept the output and what evidence they will review.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Greg:** The data team has not confirmed access yet. I had assumed the existing operational records would be available, but that is not the same as having permission.
- 12 **Elena:** Record that ⁶ _____ and its owner. We should establish the access conditions before treating the source as ready for development and testing.
- 13 **Greg:** Then four weeks may still be possible, but I should not tell other departments it is an approved delivery promise simply because I prefer that date.
- 14 **Elena:** Correct. The ⁷ _____ needs assessment alongside the work and dependencies. If the date is fixed, we need a supported scope and delivery plan within that limit.
- 15 **Greg:** I am comfortable reviewing a clearer definition first. It should show the user, the two requested capabilities, the exclusion, and the open access question.
- 16 **Elena:** That belongs in the ⁸ _____. Once the appropriate review and authorization occur, we can distinguish the approved reference from later requests to add features.
- 17 **Greg:** We should keep the requirements connected to the reason for the project. Otherwise an attractive feature may distract us from the weekly triage need.
- 18 **Elena:** Use ⁹ _____ to preserve those connections. The record should show why the work exists, how it is checked, and whether it belongs in this release.
- 19 **Greg:** Good. Please bring the definition and unresolved decisions to the review. I will not announce the date or the wider automation feature as approved today.
- 20 **Elena:** Then we can seek ¹⁰ _____ on a clear basis. The immediate result is a reviewable proposal, not a promise built from a product name and a target alone.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. business need | 2. end user | 3. out of scope | 4. deliverable | 5. acceptance criterion | 6. assumption | 7. constraint | 8. scope statement | 9. requirements traceability | 10. scope approval

An export is not automation

F Say it

A proposed first release includes a weekly export for operations leads. Automated allocation is excluded. Data access is unconfirmed, and the target date has not been approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unconfirmed / export / excluded / commitment

Sponsor: "The included capability is a weekly ¹ _____."

Manager: "Automated allocation is ² _____."

Sponsor: "Data access remains ³ _____."

Manager: "The target is not an approved ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. export | 2. excluded | 3. unconfirmed | 4. commitment

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

One late task can move the release

A Read the situation

Explain a schedule impact using dependencies, working days, and remaining durations while keeping recovery options conditional.

Planner Luis and delivery lead Anika examine a simplified working-day schedule. Testing was due at the end of day 5 and is now forecast to finish at the end of day 8. Rehearsal takes two working days after testing, followed by a one-day approval task. These finish-to-start links have no lag or buffer, and this chain controls the release milestone. Other work is on schedule. No recovery change is approved; durations and the working calendar are unchanged.

PEOPLE / Luis: Project planner | Anika: Delivery lead

EXPLAIN THE CHAIN, NOT ONLY THE LATE TASK

A listener may hear that most work is on time and assume the release is safe. Show how the delayed predecessor moves the next necessary step. State the assumptions clearly so a forecast is neither understated nor presented as an unavoidable result if a feasible recovery option later receives approval.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How late is the testing finish forecast?

A Two calendar months

B No delay

C Three working days

D Eight working days

2. When did the baseline release chain finish?

A End of day 8

B End of day 5

C End of day 10

D End of day 11

3. What is the forecast release finish with unchanged logic and durations?

A End of day 11

B End of day 8

C End of day 9

D End of day 13

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

schedule baseline

The approved timing reference used to assess project progress.

IN USE compare with the schedule baseline

schedule forecast

The current estimate of future task or milestone timing.

IN USE update the schedule forecast

working calendar

The defined days and hours available for scheduled work.

IN USE apply the working calendar

working day

A day counted as available work under the stated calendar.

IN USE state the delay in working days

activity duration

The time needed to perform a defined scheduled task.

IN USE estimate activity duration

remaining duration

The work time still needed to finish an activity.

IN USE update remaining duration

predecessor

A task whose timing affects a linked later task.

IN USE identify the predecessor

successor

A task whose timing depends on a linked earlier task.

IN USE assess the successor

finish-to-start dependency

A link requiring the predecessor to finish before the successor starts.

IN USE check a finish-to-start dependency

lag

A specified waiting interval in a dependency link.

IN USE define the lag

lead

An allowed overlap relative to a dependency link.

IN USE justify a schedule lead

critical path

The controlling task sequence determining the schedule's earliest completion.

IN USE analyze the critical path

Precision check

Baseline: testing through day 5, rehearsal days 6-7, approval day 8. Forecast: testing through day 8, rehearsal days 9-10, approval day 11. The milestone moves three working days, not three days for each downstream task.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

total float

Time an activity can move without delaying the defined project finish under the schedule model.

IN USE assess total float

free float

Time an activity can move without delaying the earliest start of its successor.

IN USE distinguish free float

milestone

A defined project event used to track an important point.

IN USE confirm the release milestone

slippage

Movement later than the stated planned timing.

IN USE report schedule slippage

downstream impact

The effect of a change on subsequent linked work.

IN USE trace the downstream impact

resequence

Change the order or logic of planned tasks.

IN USE assess whether to resequence work

fast-tracking

Overlapping work that was planned in sequence, with resulting risks.

IN USE assess fast-tracking

crashing

Shortening duration by adding resources or cost where feasible.

IN USE evaluate schedule crashing

resource leveling

Adjusting timing to resolve resource limits or conflicts.

IN USE apply resource leveling

schedule compression

Reducing planned duration through an assessed change.

IN USE assess schedule compression

recovery option

A proposed way to regain lost time or restore a milestone.

IN USE evaluate a recovery option

forecast variance

The difference between current forecast and the specified baseline.

IN USE explain the forecast variance

Precision check

This conclusion depends on the stated controlling chain, zero buffer, unchanged calendar, and fixed durations. In another project, float or different dependencies could change the result. Extra resources and overlapping tasks are proposals to assess, not automatic recovery.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

START WITH THE MOVEMENT

"Testing is forecast to finish three working days late."

NAME THE BLOCKED STEP

"Rehearsal cannot start until testing finishes."

CALCULATE THE BASELINE

"The original chain completed at the end of day 8."

QUALIFY THE ARITHMETIC

"This chain has no buffer and controls the release milestone."

STATE THE COMPARISON

"The baseline finish is day 5; the current forecast is day 8."

EXPLAIN THE SEQUENCE

"Two days of rehearsal are followed by one day of approval."

CALCULATE THE FORECAST

"With unchanged logic, the chain now completes at the end of day 11."

AVOID FALSE AVERAGING

"On-time work elsewhere does not cancel this controlling delay."

Late

Late against which baseline and calendar?

Critical

Refers to schedule control here, not merely a task that feels important.

Float

Schedule flexibility under a defined model, not unlimited spare time.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP CALENDARS CONSISTENT

"These are working days under the same calendar."

EXPLORE RESOURCES CAREFULLY

"Additional people shorten the task only if the work can use them effectively."

KEEP RECOVERY CONDITIONAL

"No schedule-recovery change has been approved."

ASK FOR A DECISION

"Compare the feasible recovery options and their consequences."

AVOID DOUBLE COUNTING

"The three-day delay moves the chain; it is not added separately at every task."

DISTINGUISH OVERLAP

"Fast-tracking changes sequencing and may create rework risk."

PRESERVE THE REFERENCE

"Update the forecast without silently rewriting the baseline."

CLOSE THE UPDATE

"Report the milestone impact, assumptions, owner, and next checkpoint."

Forecast

A current estimate that can change with new evidence.

Recover

Requires a feasible, authorized plan rather than optimism.

Parallel

Independent work does not automatically remove a controlling dependency.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement correctly reports the unchanged forecast?

- A** Every downstream task adds another three-day delay, making nine.
- B** Other on-time tasks cancel the delay automatically.
- C** Testing finishes on day 8, so release must happen that same day.
- D** Release moves from end of day 8 to end of day 11, a three-working-day delay.

2. What does the on-time status of unrelated work establish?

- A** Three working days disappear from the calendar
- B** The release has already been authorized
- C** That work is on schedule, not that this critical chain is unaffected
- D** The delayed predecessor is automatically complete

3. Which proposal is fast-tracking?

- A** Add any number of people without examining the task
- B** Rename the baseline date without a decision
- C** Treat calendar weekends as working days without a calendar change
- D** Overlap tasks previously planned in sequence, after assessing feasibility and risk

4. A different task has four days of total float and slips three days with no other changes. What follows?

- A** Its slip can be absorbed without moving the defined project finish.
- B** Every project always slips three days.
- C** The task has gained seven days of float.
- D** Float means the task can be omitted.

Answers and explanations: page 78.

One late task can move the release

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

forecast variance / total float / schedule forecast / finish-to-start dependency / schedule baseline / crashing / critical path / working calendar / fast-tracking / downstream impact

- 01 **Anika:** Testing is three working days late in the latest forecast, but most other tasks are on schedule. Can I still tell the sponsor the release date is unchanged?
- 02 **Luis:** Not with this ¹ _____. Testing controls rehearsal, and rehearsal controls the approval task. The simplified schedule has no buffer in that chain.
- 03 **Anika:** Walk me through the original dates so I can explain the impact rather than repeat a warning without showing where it comes from.
- 04 **Luis:** The ² _____ had testing finish at the end of day five. Rehearsal used days six and seven, with the approval task on day eight.
- 05 **Anika:** Now testing is forecast to finish at the end of day eight. Rehearsal cannot simply begin earlier because the test result is its required input.
- 06 **Luis:** Correct. That is a ³ _____. With no lag, rehearsal starts on day nine and takes two working days, followed by approval on day eleven.
- 07 **Anika:** So the release moves three working days, not nine. We do not add the same three-day slip again at each linked task.
- 08 **Luis:** Exactly. The ⁴ _____ carries through the chain once. Testing, rehearsal, and approval shift in sequence while their stated durations remain unchanged.
- 09 **Anika:** I want to make sure I am not mixing working days with calendar days. A weekend might otherwise make the sponsor read the dates differently.
- 10 **Luis:** Use the same ⁵ _____ for the comparison. Our planning view labels working days directly; the dated schedule still needs its holidays and available work periods applied consistently.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Anika:** Could spare time elsewhere protect the release? People often tell me there is slack in another part of the plan.
- 12 **Luis:** Check ⁶ _____ on the affected path, not a general impression that other tasks have room. The supplied chain has none, so the unchanged forecast moves.
- 13 **Anika:** What about putting more people on testing? I can present that as an option, but I should not assume the task will automatically finish sooner.
- 14 **Luis:** That would be a ⁷ _____ proposal if it feasibly shortens duration. We need to assess usable capacity, cost, coordination, and the work remaining before claiming a recovered date.
- 15 **Anika:** Another suggestion is to begin part of rehearsal before testing finishes. That changes the logic and might create rework if the results change.
- 16 **Luis:** That is ⁸ _____. It needs a specific feasible overlap and risk assessment, not simply an instruction to do everything at once.
- 17 **Anika:** Until an option is approved, I should report the current date as day eleven and keep the original day-eight commitment visible for comparison.
- 18 **Luis:** Yes. Update the ⁹ _____ without silently rewriting the baseline. Otherwise the reporting would hide the very movement the sponsor needs to understand.
- 19 **Anika:** My update will show the three-day impact, the blocked rehearsal, and the recovery options under assessment. I will not call those options a completed recovery.
- 20 **Luis:** That makes the ¹⁰ _____ clear. State the assumptions and next review point, so the sponsor can distinguish today's supported forecast from a possible future improvement.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. critical path | 2. schedule baseline | 3. finish-to-start dependency | 4. downstream impact | 5. working calendar | 6. total float | 7. crashing | 8. fast-tracking | 9. schedule forecast | 10. forecast variance

Carry the delay once

F Say it

In a simplified working-day chain, testing was due day 4 and is now forecast day 6. A one-day review must follow, with no buffer or lag. No recovery is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approved / five / two / seven

Planner: "The original chain finished on day ¹ _____."

Lead: "The forecast finish is now day ² _____."

Planner: "That is a ³ _____-working-day delay."

Lead: "No recovery has been ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. five | 2. seven | 3. two | 4. approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The supplier miss is no longer just a possibility

A Read the situation

Escalate a confirmed delivery problem while separating the known event, uncertain consequences, and unapproved response.

Project manager Rina and procurement lead Omar review a supplier commitment for October 12. The supplier has confirmed that date will be missed and gives October 15 only as an earliest possible date, not a new commitment. Testing planned for October 13 needs the delivery. The risk register still describes a possible delay with a 30% likelihood. No replacement source or recovery plan is approved. Rina must update the status, preserve the history, and request a useful escalation.

PEOPLE / Rina: Project manager | Omar: Procurement lead

ESCALATION SHOULD EXPLAIN THE NEED FOR HELP

A senior audience needs the confirmed problem, the threatened objective, and the decision or support required. A register entry is not a response plan. Avoid keeping an outdated probability merely because the final delivery date and full project impact are not yet known.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What has the supplier confirmed?

- A** The October 12 commitment will be missed.
- C** Testing has already finished.

- B** Delivery is guaranteed on October 15.
- D** A replacement source is approved.

2. What does October 15 represent?

- A** The actual receipt date
- C** The date all risk disappears

- B** The approved release date
- D** The earliest possible date mentioned, not a commitment

3. Why is the October 13 test exposed?

- A** It is unrelated to the supplier item.
- C** Every testing task always lasts thirty days.

- B** It has already passed without the item.
- D** It requires the delivery that will miss October 12.

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

risk

Uncertainty that may affect a project objective positively or negatively.

IN USE assess project risk

threat

A potential event or condition with an adverse effect.

IN USE identify a delivery threat

opportunity

Uncertainty with a potentially beneficial effect on an objective.

IN USE assess an opportunity

risk register

A record of identified risks, assessment, ownership, and responses.

IN USE maintain the risk register

issue

A present problem requiring attention or resolution.

IN USE log an issue

issue log

A record tracking current problems and their resolution.

IN USE update the issue log

risk owner

The person accountable for managing a defined risk.

IN USE assign a risk owner

action owner

The person responsible for carrying out a particular response action.

IN USE name the action owner

likelihood

The assessed chance of an uncertain event or condition.

IN USE reassess likelihood

impact

The consequence for a defined objective if an event occurs.

IN USE assess schedule impact

risk exposure

The project's susceptibility to the relevant uncertainty and consequences.

IN USE review risk exposure

trigger

A condition or event prompting a defined response.

IN USE recognize the trigger

Precision check

The missed commitment is a present issue once confirmed; the replacement date and final effect may still be uncertain. Update the issue and linked risk records without erasing the history or pretending every downstream consequence is already known.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

03

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

risk response

A planned or implemented action addressing an identified risk.

IN USE develop a risk response

mitigation

Action intended to reduce a threat's likelihood or impact.

IN USE assess mitigation

contingency plan

A prepared response to be used if specified conditions arise.

IN USE activate a contingency plan

fallback plan

An alternative response if the primary response does not work.

IN USE prepare a fallback plan

residual risk

Risk remaining after a response has been applied.

IN USE monitor residual risk

secondary risk

New risk introduced by a response to another risk.

IN USE identify secondary risks

escalation threshold

The point at which an issue or risk must be referred to higher authority.

IN USE apply the escalation threshold

escalation brief

A concise statement of the problem, consequence, and help or decision needed.

IN USE prepare an escalation brief

decision deadline

The latest time a decision is needed to support the stated plan.

IN USE state the decision deadline

contingency reserve

Provision for identified uncertainty within the applicable plan.

IN USE clarify contingency-reserve use

response status

Whether a response is proposed, approved, underway, or completed.

IN USE report response status

closure evidence

Information showing that the stated closure conditions are met.

IN USE require closure evidence

Precision check

Earliest possible October 15 is not promised October 15. A proposed alternative source is not approved mitigation or completed recovery. Separate event status, impact estimate, response status, and the evidence required to close the issue.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

STATE THE CONFIRMED EVENT

"The supplier has confirmed it will miss October 12."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"The replacement delivery date is not committed."

CONNECT THE DEPENDENCY

"The October 13 test requires this delivery."

SEPARATE CONSEQUENCES

"The delivery miss is confirmed; the full milestone impact is still being assessed."

CORRECT THE OLD WORDING

"Possible delay no longer describes the commitment status."

QUALIFY THE EARLIEST DATE

"October 15 is the earliest possibility mentioned."

KEEP THE HISTORY

"Link the issue to the original risk entry."

NAME THE OWNER

"Assign responsibility for obtaining a committed supplier recovery plan."

Possible

No longer adequate for an event already confirmed.

Earliest

A lower timing bound or possibility, not a promised arrival.

Mitigated

Identify the implemented action and remaining exposure.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

MAKE THE REQUEST ACTIONABLE

"We need a decision on the feasible response options."

DISTINGUISH PLANNING FROM ACTION

"A contingency plan must be checked before it is treated as activated."

RETAIN RESIDUAL RISK

"A response may reduce exposure without removing every uncertainty."

DEFINE CLOSURE

"Close only when the agreed evidence supports closure."

AVOID IMAGINARY RECOVERY

"No alternative source has been approved."

WATCH NEW EXPOSURE

"Expediting can introduce cost or quality risks."

SET THE DECISION TIME

"State when the decision is needed and why."

CLOSE THE ESCALATION

"Report the fact, consequence, owner, response status, and next checkpoint."

Owned

A named person is not evidence that the problem is resolved.

Escalated

Referred for attention, not automatically decided.

Closed

Requires a defined condition and evidence, not a reassuring message.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which opening is accurate now?

- A** There is only a 30% chance the original commitment will be missed.
- B** October 15 is a guaranteed recovery.
- C** The issue is closed because the supplier replied.
- D** The October 12 miss is confirmed; the replacement date remains uncommitted.

2. How should the original risk record be handled?

- A** Mark all project risks closed.
- B** Update its status and link it to the current issue while preserving history.
- C** Delete every reference so no one sees the earlier warning.
- D** Keep the old wording unchanged because impact is uncertain.

3. What should an escalation request include?

- A** A completed approval that never occurred
- B** An unsupported guarantee that testing is unaffected
- C** The confirmed problem, affected objective, options, decision owner, and needed timing
- D** Only the sentence supplier bad

4. Which is a secondary risk from using an untested replacement?

- A** Proof that all risk is eliminated
- B** A guarantee that the replacement is already accepted
- C** New quality or integration uncertainty introduced by the response
- D** The original risk entry's document color

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The supplier miss is no longer just a possibility

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

response status / action owner / contingency plan / secondary risks / risk register / issue / escalation brief / trigger / impact / closure evidence

- 01 **Rina:** The supplier has confirmed it will miss October twelfth, but our register still says possible delivery delay with a thirty-percent likelihood. That wording is now misleading.
- 02 **Omar:** We have a current ¹ _____. The uncertainty is no longer whether the original commitment will be met; it concerns the replacement timing and the consequences for our work.
- 03 **Rina:** The supplier mentioned October fifteenth as the earliest possible date. I want to make sure nobody turns that into a confirmed recovery in the project update.
- 04 **Omar:** Keep the ² _____ explicit. The supplier has not committed to the fifteenth, and we have no approved replacement source or recovery plan.
- 05 **Rina:** Testing is planned for October thirteenth and requires the delivery. That is the immediate dependency we need to show in the escalation.
- 06 **Omar:** State the ³ _____ carefully. The planned test is threatened by the confirmed miss, but we still need a supported assessment of the full milestone consequence.
- 07 **Rina:** Should we remove the original risk entry now? I do not want two records to make it look like two separate supplier problems.
- 08 **Omar:** Update the ⁴ _____ and link it to the issue log. Preserve the history and distinguish the event status rather than deleting the warning or duplicating its impact.
- 09 **Rina:** We had identified this supplier miss as a condition requiring escalation. It sounds as though that point has now been reached, regardless of the uncertain new date.
- 10 **Omar:** The ⁵ _____ has occurred. An uncertain recovery date is not a reason to postpone acknowledging the event that activates the response.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Rina:** I need someone clearly responsible for obtaining the supplier's committed plan. A general instruction to procurement will not tell the sponsor who is following up.
- 12 **Omar:** Name an ⁶ _____ for that task, with a due time and escalation route. That is separate from pretending the person can guarantee a date the supplier has not committed to.
- 13 **Rina:** There may be a contingency in the procurement plan, but we should check its conditions and availability before saying it has solved the problem.
- 14 **Omar:** Exactly. A ⁷ _____ must be usable under the current facts. A named alternative is not automatically available, qualified, authorized, or fast enough for the test.
- 15 **Rina:** If we expedite or switch sources, we may create new costs or quality questions. The escalation should not present every response as an uncomplicated improvement.
- 16 **Omar:** Those are potential ⁸ _____. Assess them alongside the remaining exposure from the original delay, and keep the response options comparable on a stated basis.
- 17 **Rina:** I will prepare a short decision request: confirmed miss, affected test, uncommitted replacement date, options under assessment, and the time when support is needed.
- 18 **Omar:** That is a useful ⁹ _____. It gives the decision maker something to act on rather than a long register entry with no clear request.
- 19 **Rina:** When the supplier sends another update, we should not close the issue merely because the wording sounds positive. We need to know what actually changed.
- 20 **Omar:** Require ¹⁰ _____. A committed plan may change the status, but completion and closure depend on the agreed conditions and verified result, not the tone of the reply.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. issue | 2. response status | 3. impact | 4. risk register | 5. trigger | 6. action owner | 7. contingency plan | 8. secondary risks | 9. escalation brief | 10. closure evidence

A confirmed miss, an uncertain replacement

F Say it

A vendor confirms it cannot deliver Tuesday. Thursday is suggested but not committed. A Wednesday test needs the item. No alternative is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

uncommitted / dependency / confirmed / approved

Manager: "Tuesday's miss is ¹ _____."

Buyer: "Thursday remains ² _____."

Manager: "The Wednesday test has a delivery ³ _____."

Buyer: "No alternative has been ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. confirmed | 2. uncommitted | 3. dependency | 4. approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A recommendation is not an approval

A Read the situation

Close a governance meeting with a clear decision status, accountable authority, and accurate record of recommendations and actions.

Project manager Rae reviews meeting notes with steering-group chair Simon. The group recommended changing a release feature, but the notes say change approved. The project governance plan reserves this change decision to the sponsor; no written delegation or sponsor decision is recorded. The group can recommend and commission analysis. Rae must correct the minutes, identify the approval route, and separate an action to prepare an assessment from authority to implement the feature change.

PEOPLE / Rae: Project manager | Simon: Steering-group chair

ASK THE AUTHORITY QUESTION BEFORE THE ROOM EMPTIES

A meeting can reach a strong recommendation without having the authority to implement it. Clarify what was decided, who can authorize the next step, and what the team may do meanwhile. This prevents a cooperative discussion from becoming an ambiguous instruction passed to delivery teams.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Who holds the stated change authority?

- | | |
|---|---------------------------------------|
| A An unnamed vendor | B The sponsor |
| C Every meeting attendee independently | D The note taker automatically |

2. What did the steering group actually do?

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A Record a sponsor approval | B Supply a written delegation |
| C Implement the feature change | D Recommend a change |

3. What may the group commission under the supplied remit?

- | | |
|--|-----------------------------------|
| A Unrestricted implementation of the change | B A false approval record |
| C A replacement of the sponsor's reserved authority | D Analysis of the proposal |

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

governance

The arrangements for project direction, decisions, oversight, and accountability.

IN USE clarify project governance

steering group

A group guiding the project within its defined authority.

IN USE convene the steering group

terms of reference

The document defining a group's purpose, membership, and remit.

IN USE check the terms of reference

remit

The area of responsibility and authority assigned to a person or group.

IN USE stay within the remit

change authority

The person or body empowered to authorize a specified change.

IN USE identify the change authority

delegated authority

Decision power explicitly assigned by an authorized person or body.

IN USE verify delegated authority

approval threshold

A boundary determining the level of authorization required.

IN USE apply the approval threshold

decision rights

Defined responsibility for making particular decisions.

IN USE confirm decision rights

recommendation

A proposed course of action submitted for consideration.

IN USE record a recommendation

endorsement

Expressed support that may not itself constitute formal approval.

IN USE distinguish endorsement from approval

authorization

Permission from the appropriate authority to take the stated action.

IN USE obtain authorization

quorum

The minimum participation required for a body's valid proceedings under its rules.

IN USE confirm a quorum

Precision check

Consensus in the steering group does not override the sponsor authority stated in this case. A quorum only answers whether the group can validly conduct its own business; it does not enlarge its remit or create an unrecorded delegation.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

consensus

Broad agreement among participants on a stated matter.

IN USE establish the scope of consensus

dissent

A stated disagreement with a proposal or conclusion.

IN USE record material dissent

decision log

A record of actual decisions, authority, conditions, and dates.

IN USE maintain the decision log

action log

A record of assigned tasks, owners, deadlines, and status.

IN USE update the action log

minutes

The formal record of a meeting's relevant proceedings and outcomes.

IN USE correct the minutes

escalation route

The path for referring a matter beyond the current authority.

IN USE use the escalation route

stage gate

A defined review point for an authorization or continuation decision.

IN USE prepare for a stage gate

assurance review

An examination intended to provide confidence in delivery or controls.

IN USE commission an assurance review

accountability

Answerability for a defined decision or result.

IN USE assign accountability

RACI

A responsibility model distinguishing responsible, accountable, consulted, and informed roles.

IN USE clarify the RACI roles

decision paper

A document presenting the issue, options, consequences, and requested decision.

IN USE prepare a decision paper

conditional approval

Authorization limited by explicit conditions.

IN USE record conditional approval

Precision check

An action to prepare analysis is not an instruction to implement the change. Minutes should distinguish recommendation, analysis action, approval request, and actual decision. If an approval is conditional, both the conditions and their status must remain visible.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CHECK THE RECORD

"The minutes say approved, but the group made a recommendation."

ASK ABOUT DELEGATION

"Is there an explicit delegation covering this change?"

CLARIFY THE REMIT

"The group can recommend and commission analysis."

FRAME THE REQUEST

"The sponsor needs the options, impacts, and specific decision sought."

NAME THE AUTHORITY

"The governance plan reserves this decision to the sponsor."

SEPARATE AGREEMENT

"Consensus here does not by itself provide implementation authority."

DISTINGUISH THE ACTION

"Preparing the assessment is not approval to implement."

PRESERVE DISSENT

"Record material objections accurately rather than inventing unanimity."

Supported

May mean endorsed, not authorized.

Approved

State by whom, for what, and under which conditions.

Aligned

Clarify whether people agree on the problem, recommendation, or actual action.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CORRECT THE STATUS

"Mark the change as recommended, with approval pending."

KEEP DELIVERY INFORMED

"Tell the team exactly what work is authorized meanwhile."

CHECK A CONDITION

"State what must happen before a conditional approval takes effect."

KEEP THE RECORDS DISTINCT

"Put decisions in the decision log and tasks in the action log."

ASSIGN THE PREPARATION

"Name the owner and deadline for the decision paper."

AVOID A SILENT DECISION

"No objection in the meeting is not a recorded sponsor approval."

CONFIRM THE OUTCOME

"Read back the decision, authority, limits, and action owners."

CLOSE THE ROUTE

"Send the recommendation through the defined approval route."

Quorate

Valid attendance does not create authority outside the group's remit.

Consulted

Asked for input, not necessarily empowered to approve.

Pending

An open status that must remain visible to implementation teams.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which correction belongs in the minutes?

- A** All decision rights transferred automatically to the chair
- B** Change recommended; sponsor approval pending; analysis commissioned
- C** Sponsor approved despite no recorded decision
- D** Change implemented because the room agreed

2. What does the group's consensus establish?

- A** Automatic transfer of the sponsor's authority
- B** Proof of an unrecorded written delegation
- C** Unlimited power to change every baseline
- D** Support for a recommendation within its remit

3. Which task can proceed under the supplied facts?

- A** Implementing the proposed feature change as approved
- B** Announcing a sponsor decision that is absent
- C** Erasing the approval requirement from the record
- D** Preparing the commissioned impact analysis

4. Which record best captures conditional approval if it is later given?

- A** The actual approver, permitted change, explicit conditions, and condition status
- B** Only the word approved without limits
- C** A claim that every possible change is authorized
- D** A recommendation relabeled as approval before the sponsor acts

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

A recommendation is not an approval

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

terms of reference / recommendation / delegated authority / dissent / authorization / conditional approval / action log / decision paper / decision log / quorum

- 01 **Simon:** The meeting seemed aligned on changing the feature, and the notes say change approved. I assumed that reflected the room, but you have flagged the wording.
- 02 **Rae:** The room made a ¹ _____. Our governance plan reserves this decision to the sponsor, and the record contains neither a sponsor decision nor an explicit delegation.
- 03 **Simon:** We had enough members present and everyone supported the proposal. Does that not give the group authority to move the change forward?
- 04 **Rae:** A ² _____ lets the group conduct business under its rules. It does not expand the remit or replace a decision explicitly reserved to someone else.
- 05 **Simon:** Then I need to distinguish agreement about what we should recommend from authority to tell the delivery team to build it.
- 06 **Rae:** Exactly. Check the ³ _____. This group can recommend and commission analysis; it cannot treat its own enthusiasm as permission outside the authority the project has assigned.
- 07 **Simon:** There may be a delegation somewhere, but I have not seen one. I should not ask the team to proceed on the assumption that it probably exists.
- 08 **Rae:** Verify ⁴ _____ before relying on it. Until then, the sponsor remains the stated decision maker for this change, and the implementation status should remain pending.
- 09 **Simon:** We did assign someone to assess the impact. I want that work to proceed, because the sponsor will need a clearer comparison of the options.
- 10 **Rae:** Put that in the ⁵ _____. The task is to prepare analysis with an owner and deadline; it is not an instruction to implement the feature change.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Simon:** What should the sponsor receive? Sending the meeting transcript would show the discussion, but might not make the actual choice very clear.
- 12 **Rae:** Prepare a ⁶ _____. Include the options, consequences, recommendation, and specific authorization sought, along with the date when the decision is needed for delivery planning.
- 13 **Simon:** I will correct the minutes to say recommended rather than approved. Should we also explain that the analysis is authorized while implementation is not?
- 14 **Rae:** Yes. Keep ⁷ _____ attached to the specific action. Otherwise the team may hear that work can proceed and assume that means the change itself.
- 15 **Simon:** We should preserve any material objections as well. A short record does not need every comment, but it should not rewrite a qualified view as complete agreement.
- 16 **Rae:** Record material ⁸ _____ accurately. The sponsor needs the substantive concerns, not a smoother account that hides the trade-off the group actually discussed.
- 17 **Simon:** If the sponsor later approves with conditions, the delivery team needs those conditions too. The word approved on its own would still be incomplete.
- 18 **Rae:** A ⁹ _____ must state the limits and what must be satisfied. We should not silently treat an unmet condition as though it has already been cleared.
- 19 **Simon:** I will read back the corrected result: recommendation supported, assessment commissioned, sponsor decision pending. Then we will send the paper through the stated route.
- 20 **Rae:** Update the ¹⁰ _____ accordingly and tell the delivery team the same status. A clear handoff will preserve both useful progress and the actual boundary on implementation.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. recommendation | 2. quorum | 3. terms of reference | 4. delegated authority | 5. action log | 6. decision paper | 7. authorization | 8. dissent | 9. conditional approval | 10. decision log

Authorize analysis, not implementation

F Say it

A committee may commission analysis but cannot approve a cost change. It recommends an option and requests an assessment. The finance sponsor has not decided.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

pending / assessment / authorized / recommendation

Chair: "The committee has made a ¹ _____."

Manager: "The authorized next task is the ² _____."

Chair: "The sponsor's decision is still ³ _____."

Manager: "Implementation is not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. recommendation | 2. assessment | 3. pending | 4. authorized

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Just one more report before launch

A Read the situation

Respond constructively to a late scope request by comparing explicit options, effort, schedule effects, and approval status.

05

Two weeks before launch, sponsor Nadia asks project manager Chen to add a new report. The current plan uses all 20 remaining person-days. The report is estimated at four person-days including testing. The team has assessed two feasible options: defer an existing four-person-day export feature and retain the launch date, or keep all features and extend the schedule by two working days using the planned team. Both need approval. No overtime, extra staff, or reduced testing is assumed.

PEOPLE / Nadia: Project sponsor | Chen: Project manager

A CONSTRUCTIVE BOUNDARY INCLUDES OPTIONS

A sponsor may hear an immediate no as resistance, but an unqualified yes can conceal a delivery problem. Acknowledge the value, explain the capacity limit, and present the assessed options. The decision is about priorities and consequences, not whether the team is sufficiently willing.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How much effort is estimated for the new report?

A Twenty person-days of confirmed extra capacity

C Two person-days excluding testing

B Four person-days including testing

D Zero because the report is requested late

2. Which assessed option retains the launch date?

A Remove testing from the report

C Keep every feature with no other change

B Defer the existing four-person-day export feature

D Add unapproved overtime automatically

3. What is the status of both options?

A The new launch date is already the baseline.

C Both are already approved simultaneously.

B They need approval.

D The export has already been removed.

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

change request

A recorded proposal to alter agreed project work or parameters.

IN USE raise a change request

change control

The process for assessing and deciding changes to an approved reference.

IN USE follow change control

scope creep

Uncontrolled growth in project work without corresponding assessment and authorization.

IN USE prevent scope creep

change log

A record of proposed and decided project changes.

IN USE update the change log

impact assessment

Analysis of how a proposal affects relevant project dimensions.

IN USE complete an impact assessment

effort estimate

The amount of work expected, expressed in person-time or another work unit.

IN USE qualify the effort estimate

person-day

One person's defined day of work used as an effort unit.

IN USE estimate effort in person-days

elapsed duration

The time passing from an activity's start to finish.

IN USE distinguish elapsed duration

capacity limit

The amount of work the stated resources can support.

IN USE explain the capacity limit

trade-off

A choice between competing benefits, costs, or constraints.

IN USE present the trade-off

scope substitution

Replacing one part of planned work with another under an authorized change.

IN USE assess a scope substitution

deferred feature

A capability moved out of the current delivery scope or timing.

IN USE identify the deferred feature

Precision check

Four person-days is effort; two working days is an assessed schedule extension with the planned team. They are not interchangeable units. The supplied options already include testing and assume no extra staff or overtime.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

incremental cost

Additional cost caused by the proposed change.

IN USE assess incremental cost

opportunity cost

Value forgone by choosing one use of resources over another.

IN USE explain the opportunity cost

benefit impact

The effect of a change on the value expected from the project.

IN USE assess benefit impact

rework

Work repeated or revised because of a change or defect.

IN USE estimate rework

test coverage

The extent to which specified requirements or conditions are tested.

IN USE preserve required test coverage

release boundary

The defined set of capabilities included in a particular release.

IN USE clarify the release boundary

change freeze

A point or period limiting changes under the project's stated rules.

IN USE apply the change-freeze rules

baseline revision

An authorized update to the controlled project reference.

IN USE record a baseline revision

approval record

Evidence of the actual authorization and its limits.

IN USE retain the approval record

implementation instruction

A clear direction specifying the authorized change to perform.

IN USE issue an implementation instruction

option comparison

An assessment of alternatives on a consistent basis.

IN USE prepare an option comparison

decision latency

Time between needing a decision and receiving it.

IN USE account for decision latency

Precision check

Deferring the export preserves the date but changes the delivered capability and possible benefit. Keeping all features preserves scope but moves timing. Neither is a free addition, and an authorized change is not the same as uncontrolled scope creep.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE VALUE

"I understand why the new report would be useful at launch."

QUANTIFY THE ADDITION

"The report is estimated at four person-days including testing."

PRESENT THE SUBSTITUTION

"We can retain the date by deferring the existing export feature."

NAME THE LOST CAPABILITY

"The substitution means the export is not in this release."

STATE THE CURRENT LIMIT

"The plan already uses all 20 remaining person-days."

AVOID UNIT CONFUSION

"Effort is four person-days; the assessed extension is two working days."

PRESENT THE TIMING OPTION

"We can keep all features with the assessed two-working-day extension."

KEEP ASSUMPTIONS VISIBLE

"Neither option assumes extra staff, overtime, or reduced testing."

Small

A description that does not replace an effort estimate.

Just

Can conceal additional work when used before a new requirement.

Can

State the conditions under which delivery is feasible.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PROTECT THE DECISION

"We need approval before changing the committed scope or date."

COMPARE CONSEQUENCES

"Review the timing and benefit effects on the same basis."

RECORD THE REQUEST

"Put the new report and its impacts in the change record."

PRESERVE THE BASELINE

"Update the controlled plan only after the actual decision."

SEPARATE VALUE AND CAPACITY

"A valuable request still consumes delivery effort."

AVOID A HIDDEN SHORTCUT

"Removing required testing is not one of the assessed options."

CHECK DECISION TIMING

"A late decision may require the estimates to be refreshed."

CLOSE THE CHOICE

"Confirm which option is approved and what the team should implement."

Swap

Still changes scope and may change expected value.

Estimate

A supported forecast, not an unconditional guarantee.

Approved

Identify the selected option, limits, and implementation date.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response is both constructive and accurate?

- A** We can assess the new value through the two stated options, each with a consequence and approval need.
- B** Yes, everything fits unchanged because the sponsor asked.
- C** No change can ever be considered in a project.
- D** Testing can be silently removed to make room.

2. Why does the four-person-day estimate not mean a four-day extension here?

- A** The original plan contains unlimited unused capacity.
- B** Effort and elapsed duration differ; the assessed team plan gives two working days.
- C** Person-days are the same as calendar days in every case.
- D** Testing has been excluded without disclosure.

3. What must the date-preserving option disclose?

- A** Every original capability remains unchanged.
- B** The new report needs no testing.
- C** The scope baseline has already been revised.
- D** The existing export will be deferred from this release.

4. What turns an addition into uncontrolled scope creep?

- A** Implementing extra work without the required assessment and authorization
- B** Recording and approving a supported change
- C** Comparing options before a decision
- D** Updating the baseline after proper approval

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

Just one more report before launch

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

test coverage / baseline revision / benefit impact / option comparison / change request / decision latency / approval record / effort estimate / elapsed duration / scope substitution

- 01 **Nadia:** Could we add one more report before launch? It would be useful for the operations review, and I hope it is a small enough change to fit.
- 02 **Chen:** Let us record the ¹ _____. The current plan already uses all twenty remaining person-days, so the report cannot be treated as an addition with no consequence.
- 03 **Nadia:** I understand it needs work. What does the estimate include? I do not want a build estimate that leaves testing to become a surprise later.
- 04 **Chen:** The ² _____ is four person-days including testing. The team has assessed two options using the planned people, with no extra staff or overtime assumed.
- 05 **Nadia:** Please explain those options in terms of the launch and what users will receive. That will help me compare the value instead of debating whether four is a big number.
- 06 **Chen:** The first is a ³ _____. Defer the existing four-person-day export feature and use that capacity for the new report, retaining the launch date.
- 07 **Nadia:** That preserves the date but removes something people expected. We should make the lost capability visible rather than describe the option as simply fitting the report in.
- 08 **Chen:** Exactly. Assess the ⁴ _____ of deferring the export. A date-preserving option still changes the release content and may affect the work users can do.
- 09 **Nadia:** What is the second option if the export remains important enough that we should not remove it from this release?
- 10 **Chen:** Keep all features and accept the assessed ⁵ _____ increase of two working days. That is the team's schedule assessment, not a claim that four person-days always equals two days.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

05

- 11 **Nadia:** Both options include the same testing expectation, correct? I would not want an apparently unchanged date achieved by quietly leaving out required checks.
- 12 **Chen:** Correct. We have not reduced ⁶ _____ to create either option. If someone proposes a different approach, it needs its own assessment rather than being smuggled into the estimate.
- 13 **Nadia:** We should compare the two options together: date retained with export deferred, or all features retained with a later launch. Neither means no trade-off.
- 14 **Chen:** That is the ⁷ _____. Include the assumptions and any relevant consequences so the decision is about the actual alternatives, not a more attractive label.
- 15 **Nadia:** I am not choosing an option in this conversation yet. I need to confirm the export's importance with the operations lead before making the decision.
- 16 **Chen:** Then the ⁸ _____ should remain pending. The delivery team should not infer an instruction to remove the export or move the date from our discussion of possibilities.
- 17 **Nadia:** When would you need the decision? If I leave it too long, the plan may change as the team completes work already assigned.
- 18 **Chen:** We must account for ⁹ _____. Confirm a decision checkpoint with the team; if the work has moved on, refresh the assessment rather than reuse an estimate whose assumptions no longer hold.
- 19 **Nadia:** Once the decision is made, we should tell stakeholders exactly what changed. I do not want one audience expecting the original export and another expecting the new report.
- 20 **Chen:** Issue the authorized ¹⁰ _____ and implementation instruction together. That gives the team and stakeholders one supported version of the release instead of several incompatible promises.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. change request | 2. effort estimate | 3. scope substitution | 4. benefit impact | 5. elapsed duration | 6. test coverage | 7. option comparison | 8. approval record | 9. decision latency | 10. baseline revision

A substitution changes scope

F Say it

A new feature needs three person-days. The assessed date-preserving option removes another three-person-day feature. Both cannot fit under the unchanged plan, and no option is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approval / deferred / effort / substitution

Sponsor: "The new feature requires three person-days of ¹ _____."

Manager: "Keeping the date requires the assessed scope ² _____."

Sponsor: "The original feature would be ³ _____."

Manager: "The option still needs ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. effort | 2. substitution | 3. deferred | 4. approval

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened

A Read the situation

Produce a concise executive update that shows material threats, rating criteria, and decision needs without confusing task counts with delivery confidence.

06

Project lead Sofia and sponsor James review a green report. Eight of ten tasks are complete, but the remaining access approval is needed by October 9 for an October 12 rehearsal before the planned October 16 launch. Approval is unconfirmed. The fictional reporting rules require amber when a material threat needs management attention and green only when delivery is on track without such a threat. No effort weights, cost data, approved recovery, or confirmed launch delay are supplied.

PEOPLE / Sofia: Project lead | James: Project sponsor

A COLOR SHOULD INVITE THE RIGHT CONVERSATION

Use the agreed reporting rules rather than choosing the color that sounds most reassuring. A material threat can require attention before a date is actually missed. A concise update should identify the dependency, consequence, owner, and needed action, not hide the problem behind a long list of completed work.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does eight of ten establish?

- A** The final access approval is already granted.
- B** Eighty percent of the task count is complete.
- C** Eighty percent of all effort is complete.
- D** The launch date is guaranteed.

2. Why does the access approval matter?

- A** It proves all ten tasks are finished.
- B** It replaces every release decision.
- C** It is needed for the rehearsal that precedes launch.
- D** It is unrelated to remaining work.

3. Which rating matches the supplied rules and facts?

- A** Automatically red because any uncertainty means failure
- B** No rating because the threat is not yet a confirmed delay
- C** Amber
- D** Green because most task boxes are complete

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

status report

A periodic account of progress, outlook, problems, and decisions needed.

IN USE prepare a status report

status date

The date to which the reported information applies.

IN USE state the status date

reporting period

The time interval covered by a report.

IN USE define the reporting period

RAG rating

A red-amber-green status classification under stated criteria.

IN USE apply the RAG rating

green status

An on-track classification under the project's defined reporting rules.

IN USE justify green status

amber status

A warning classification requiring attention under the defined rules.

IN USE explain amber status

red status

A serious-problem classification under the defined reporting rules.

IN USE explain red status

delivery confidence

An assessment of the likelihood of achieving the intended delivery outcome.

IN USE assess delivery confidence

key milestone

A major event used to judge project progress or readiness.

IN USE report a key milestone

dependency owner

The person accountable for managing a required external or linked input.

IN USE identify the dependency owner

dependency due date

The date a required input must be available for the plan.

IN USE confirm the dependency due date

leading indicator

A signal of a possible future result or problem.

IN USE monitor a leading indicator

Precision check

Eight of ten means 80% of task count, not necessarily 80% of effort, value, or readiness. Unequal task sizes and a controlling dependency make that distinction important. No earned-value or cost-performance result can be calculated from these counts alone.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

lagging indicator

A measure of an outcome that has already occurred.

IN USE distinguish a lagging indicator

exception report

A focused report on a deviation or condition requiring attention.

IN USE raise an exception report

percent complete

Completion expressed as a percentage under a specified measurement basis.

IN USE define percent complete

task-count completion

The share of listed tasks marked complete without weighting their effort.

IN USE qualify task-count completion

weighted progress

Progress calculated using stated effort, value, or other weights.

IN USE report weighted progress

earned value

The budgeted value of work actually completed under a defined measurement method.

IN USE distinguish earned value

planned value

The budgeted value of work planned by the status date.

IN USE compare with planned value

actual cost

Cost incurred for the work under the stated accounting basis.

IN USE report actual cost

cost performance index

Earned value divided by actual cost, commonly CPI.

IN USE interpret the cost performance index

schedule performance index

Earned value divided by planned value, commonly SPI.

IN USE interpret the schedule performance index

confidence qualifier

Wording that states a forecast's uncertainty or conditions.

IN USE add a confidence qualifier

executive ask

The specific decision or support requested from senior management.

IN USE state the executive ask

06

Precision check

Under these fictional rules, the open material threat warrants amber even before a confirmed launch delay. That does not prove October 16 is impossible. Report the planned date, uncertainty, dependency deadline, and required attention without inventing either certainty or failure.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

LEAD WITH THE EXCEPTION

"The access dependency threatens the planned launch sequence."

KEEP PROGRESS VISIBLE

"Eight of ten listed tasks are complete."

NAME THE MISSING INPUT

"The access approval is still unconfirmed."

CONNECT THE MILESTONE

"Rehearsal is planned for October 12 before the October 16 launch."

STATE THE RATING BASIS

"Our rules require amber for a material threat needing management attention."

QUALIFY THE PERCENTAGE

"That is task-count completion, not weighted effort."

GIVE THE NEEDED-BY DATE

"We need that approval by October 9."

AVOID UNSUPPORTED CERTAINTY

"The launch is not yet confirmed delayed, but the threat is material."

06

Green

Apply the actual criteria, not the mood of the meeting.

Complete

Complete under which definition and measurement method?

Eighty percent

State the denominator and any weighting.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A FALSE GREEN

"Completed tasks do not remove the remaining dependency."

STATE THE EXECUTIVE ASK

"We need help securing a timely decision through the authorized route."

SEPARATE DATA GAPS

"These task counts do not provide earned-value or cost information."

REPORT CHANGE HONESTLY

"Update the outlook when evidence changes, not when a color becomes uncomfortable."

NAME THE OWNER

"Identify who is responsible for obtaining the approval."

KEEP THE BASELINE VISIBLE

"The planned launch remains October 16 pending further evidence or approval."

SET THE CHECKPOINT

"Confirm when the approval status will next be reviewed."

CLOSE IN ONE SEQUENCE

"Rating, dependency, impact, owner, needed action, next update."

06

Threatened

A material uncertainty, not necessarily a confirmed delay.

On track

Needs a supported outlook for the remaining work.

Escalation

A request for attention or decision, not automatic authorization.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which executive summary is best supported?

- A** Amber: access due October 9 is unconfirmed; rehearsal and launch are exposed; owner and decision follow-up needed.
- B** Green: 80% of tasks means 80% certainty of launch.
- C** Red: October 16 is definitely impossible on the supplied facts.
- D** All work is complete except tasks that do not matter.

2. Why is "80% of the project is done" too broad?

- A** Eight divided by ten is not 80%.
- B** Every task must have identical effort by definition.
- C** The count proves all remaining tasks are optional.
- D** Only unweighted task counts are supplied.

3. What would be needed to calculate CPI?

- A** The planned launch date alone
- B** Earned value and actual cost on a defined basis
- C** Only the number of green tasks
- D** A list of meeting attendees

4. Which wording preserves uncertainty accurately?

- A** No update is needed until after the date is missed.
- B** October 16 remains planned, but the unconfirmed dependency creates a material threat.
- C** October 16 is guaranteed because it is printed in the plan.
- D** October 16 has definitely failed because a threat exists.

Answers and explanations: page 86.

Eight tasks finished, one date still threatened

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

dependency due date / confidence qualifier / executive ask / exception report / task-count completion / RAG rating / Delivery confidence / dependency owner / status date / Earned value

- 01 **James:** The report is green and shows eight of ten tasks complete. That sounds encouraging, but I see the access approval is still open. Does it affect the rehearsal?
- 02 **Sofia:** Yes. Our ¹ _____ should reflect that dependency. The supplied rules require amber when a material threat needs management attention, even before a milestone is confirmed late.
- 03 **James:** Then the eight completed tasks are useful progress, but they do not settle whether the remaining sequence can happen on time.
- 04 **Sofia:** Exactly. That is ² _____, not eighty percent of all effort or readiness. The remaining tasks may differ in size, and one contains the input needed for rehearsal.
- 05 **James:** Please state the dates in the short update. I need to see the point at which the missing approval affects the rest of the plan.
- 06 **Sofia:** The ³ _____ is October ninth. Rehearsal is planned for October twelfth, ahead of the October sixteenth launch, so the approval cannot remain an unrelated footnote.
- 07 **James:** We do not yet know that launch will be late, though. I want the report to show the threat without declaring a final outcome the evidence does not establish.
- 08 **Sofia:** Use a ⁴ _____: October sixteenth remains planned, but the access dependency is unconfirmed and threatens the sequence. No recovery or revised date has been approved.
- 09 **James:** Who is responsible for obtaining the approval? A clear owner would help me understand where support is needed instead of sending a general chase to everyone.
- 10 **Sofia:** Identify the ⁵ _____ and the authorized decision route. The report should say who is following up, what decision is required, and when the next status check will occur.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **James:** I can help bring the decision to the right forum, but I cannot treat the urgency as permission to bypass the access approval itself.
- 12 **Sofia:** That is the appropriate ⁶ _____. We need support securing a timely decision through the proper route, not an assurance that an unapproved input can be treated as available.
- 13 **James:** The report also uses the words value delivered beside the eighty-percent figure. We do not have an earned-value calculation here, do we?
- 14 **Sofia:** No. ⁷ _____ needs its defined work and budget basis. The task count supplies neither that measure nor the actual cost needed for a cost-performance calculation.
- 15 **James:** So the update should be shorter but more precise: real progress, the material threat, the needed decision, and the timing. We can remove the unsupported value label.
- 16 **Sofia:** An ⁸ _____ can make that concise. It should expose the access issue without forcing the sponsor to discover it inside a long list of activities that are already finished.
- 17 **James:** I agree that amber follows our rules. It is not a punishment for the team; it tells us where management attention can still make a difference.
- 18 **Sofia:** Correct. ⁹ _____ depends on the remaining work and dependencies, not just historical completion. The rating should change when the relevant evidence changes.
- 19 **James:** Please correct the report and confirm the next checkpoint. Keep the October sixteenth baseline visible while distinguishing it from any later forecast we may need.
- 20 **Sofia:** I will state the ¹⁰ _____ and current approval position, change the rating to amber, and include the owner and decision follow-up. That gives the next audience the same accurate picture.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. RAG rating | 2. task-count completion | 3. dependency due date | 4. confidence qualifier | 5. dependency owner | 6. executive ask | 7. Earned value | 8. exception report | 9. Delivery confidence | 10. status date

Counted progress does not remove a blocker

F Say it

Six of eight tasks are complete. A material dependency remains open. The local rules require amber for that threat, and no final delay is confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

progress / seventy-five / confirmed / amber

Lead: "Task-count completion is ¹ _____ percent."

Sponsor: "That does not establish weighted ² _____."

Lead: "Under our rules, the rating is ³ _____."

Sponsor: "A final delay is not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. seventy-five | 2. progress | 3. amber | 4. confirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted

A Read the situation

Resolve a delivery-status disagreement by linking agreed criteria to evidence, distinguishing missing proof from failure, and naming the acceptance authority.

Vendor lead Marta says a workflow deliverable is complete. Client acceptance lead Leo can verify four of six agreed criteria, but finds no evidence for C5, audit-log export, or C6, role-based access behavior. The missing evidence does not itself prove those functions fail. No acceptance or waiver is recorded, and Leo cannot waive criteria alone. Contractual payment consequences have not been assessed. Leo and Marta must agree the evidence handoff without adding new scope or treating the delivery claim as acceptance.

PEOPLE / Leo: Client acceptance lead | Marta: Vendor delivery lead

07

BE FIRM ABOUT EVIDENCE WITHOUT ESCALATING THE TONE

A vendor can mean development complete while the client means accepted against the agreed criteria. State the missing evidence and identifiers precisely. This keeps the discussion focused on the original agreement instead of implying new requirements, accusing someone of failure without proof, or approving an incomplete record.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many criteria currently have verified evidence?

- | | |
|----------------------|------------------|
| A Two of six | B None |
| C Four of six | D All six |

2. What follows from missing evidence for C5 and C6?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Both criteria are automatically waived. | B The client has accepted all work. |
| C Their compliance has not yet been demonstrated in the record. | D Both functions are proven defective. |

3. Who may waive the criteria under the supplied facts?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A The appropriate authority, which Leo cannot replace alone | B Leo automatically because the vendor says complete |
| C Any observer at a demonstration | D No authorization is ever relevant |

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

statement of work

The agreed description of the vendor's work and deliverables, commonly SOW.

IN USE refer to the statement of work

deliverable register

A record of promised outputs and their current status.

IN USE update the deliverable register

acceptance plan

The arrangement for checking and deciding acceptance of outputs.

IN USE confirm the acceptance plan

acceptance authority

The person or body empowered to accept the deliverable.

IN USE identify the acceptance authority

acceptance evidence

Information demonstrating whether the agreed criteria are met.

IN USE supply acceptance evidence

requirements matrix

A table linking requirements to identifiers, status, or supporting information.

IN USE review the requirements matrix

evidence gap

Missing information needed to support a conclusion.

IN USE identify an evidence gap

test result

The recorded outcome of a defined test.

IN USE review a test result

test environment

The conditions and setup in which a test is performed.

IN USE identify the test environment

test data

The inputs used in a defined test.

IN USE specify the test data

expected result

The outcome required by the applicable test or criterion.

IN USE compare with the expected result

actual result

The outcome observed when the defined test is performed.

IN USE record the actual result

Precision check

Four of six criteria have verified evidence. C5 and C6 are unverified in this record, not automatically failed or waived. A vendor completion claim and formal client acceptance are different statuses; neither substitutes for the other.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

defect

A departure from a specified requirement or expected behavior.

IN USE log a verified defect

nonconformance

Failure to meet an applicable specified requirement.

IN USE document a nonconformance

punch list

A list of remaining items to address before a defined completion point.

IN USE maintain a punch list

waiver

An authorized exception to a specified requirement under the governing rules.

IN USE request a waiver

conditional acceptance

Acceptance limited by explicit unresolved conditions under the relevant authority.

IN USE document conditional acceptance

formal acceptance

Recorded acceptance by the authorized party under the applicable process.

IN USE confirm formal acceptance

handover package

The documents, outputs, and evidence transferred to the receiving team.

IN USE complete the handover package

completion claim

A party's statement that its work is finished.

IN USE verify a completion claim

commercial consequence

An effect on contractual or financial obligations requiring the governing terms.

IN USE assess commercial consequences

contract owner

The person responsible for managing the relevant agreement.

IN USE consult the contract owner

acceptance record

The documented acceptance decision and its basis or conditions.

IN USE retain the acceptance record

evidence handoff

Transfer of identifiable supporting information to the reviewer.

IN USE agree the evidence handoff

Precision check

Request evidence against the agreed criteria, including the relevant test context, expected result, and actual result. Do not invent new requirements during acceptance. Payment or contractual remedies need the governing terms and proper authority, not an assumption from a status label.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CLAIM

"I understand that your team considers development complete."

NAME THE GAPS

"Evidence for C5 and C6 is missing from the handover package."

KEEP SCOPE STABLE

"We are asking for proof against existing criteria, not adding requirements."

CLARIFY THE TEST CONTEXT

"Identify the environment, inputs, expected result, and actual result."

STATE THE EVIDENCE POSITION

"We can verify four of the six agreed criteria."

AVOID A FALSE FAILURE

"Missing evidence does not itself establish a failed function."

REQUEST TRACEABILITY

"Link each result to its criterion identifier and tested version."

SEPARATE THE STATUSES

"Delivered is not the same as formally accepted."

07

Complete

Name whose work stage and which completion definition.

Unverified

Not demonstrated; it does not automatically mean defective.

Failed

Requires evidence against the relevant criterion.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP THE AUTHORITY VISIBLE

"I cannot waive these criteria on my own."

QUALIFY CONDITIONAL ACCEPTANCE

"Any conditional acceptance needs proper authority and explicit conditions."

AVOID PREMATURE CLOSURE

"Keep the two criteria open until the evidence is assessed."

CONFIRM THE HANDOFF

"Name the sender, reviewer, file location, and next checkpoint."

AVOID IMPLIED ACCEPTANCE

"A demonstration invitation is not an acceptance record."

SET THE EVIDENCE DEADLINE

"Confirm when the missing evidence will be available for review."

HANDLE TERMS CORRECTLY

"Refer payment consequences to the contract owner and governing agreement."

CLOSE WITH THE ACTUAL STATE

"Four verified, two awaiting evidence, acceptance not yet recorded."

Waived

Requires an actual authorized exception.

Conditional

Keep the condition visible instead of shortening it to accepted.

Paid

A commercial status whose relation to acceptance depends on the agreement.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response preserves both accuracy and scope?

- A** Please supply evidence for the existing C5 and C6 criteria; we are not adding new requirements.
- B** Both functions are proven failures because evidence is missing.
- C** Every function is accepted because the vendor is confident.
- D** We can add unrelated requirements without a change discussion.

07

2. What should an evidence package make traceable?

- A** Criterion, tested version, context, and actual result against expectation
- B** Only a slide saying done
- C** The vendor's preferred payment date alone
- D** The number of people who attended a meeting

3. Which acceptance status is supported now?

- A** No acceptance or waiver is recorded.
- B** Unconditional formal acceptance is complete.
- C** C5 and C6 have been waived by silence.
- D** Leo has unlimited unilateral waiver authority.

4. What should be said about payment consequences?

- A** They need assessment against the agreement by the appropriate owner.
- B** Missing evidence automatically cancels every payment in all contracts.
- C** A completion claim proves immediate payment under every agreement.
- D** The project team may invent a new commercial term.

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

Complete on the vendor side, not yet accepted

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

acceptance record / conditional acceptance / waiver / evidence handoff / evidence gap / statement of work / actual result / completion claim / contract owner / requirements matrix

07

- 01 **Marta:** Our team has marked the workflow deliverable complete. I thought that meant we could close the delivery item, but your acceptance sheet still shows two open entries.
- 02 **Leo:** I see the ¹ _____. We can verify four of the six agreed criteria; the handover package has no evidence for C5 or C6.
- 03 **Marta:** Those are audit-log export and role-based access behavior. Are you saying the functions have failed, or that you cannot find the supporting results?
- 04 **Leo:** I am identifying an ² _____. Missing results do not prove the functions fail, but they do prevent us from treating those criteria as demonstrated in the current record.
- 05 **Marta:** That distinction helps. I was concerned the review was adding new scope after the team had finished development and prepared the handover.
- 06 **Leo:** We are referring to the existing ³ _____ and agreed criteria. The request is for evidence supporting C5 and C6, not additional functionality outside that agreement.
- 07 **Marta:** What would make the package usable for your reviewers? We may have screenshots and test records, but they need to be connected to the right version.
- 08 **Leo:** Use the ⁴ _____ to identify the criterion, tested version, and result. Reviewers should not have to infer which requirement a screenshot is intended to demonstrate.
- 09 **Marta:** We should include the environment and test inputs too. A result from an unrelated setup may not demonstrate the behavior your agreed test expects.
- 10 **Leo:** Exactly. State the ⁵ _____ alongside the expected result and context. That lets us assess the evidence rather than accept a general statement that the test passed.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Marta:** If the evidence takes another day to assemble, could you simply waive those two criteria so the handover record can be closed now?
- 12 **Leo:** I cannot issue a ⁶ _____ on my own. The proper authority would need to decide any exception under the agreement; a missing document does not itself justify pretending the requirement disappeared.
- 13 **Marta:** Could conditional acceptance be considered instead? I am asking about the process, not assuming that it has already been granted.
- 14 **Leo:** Any ⁷ _____ needs the proper decision and clear terms. We have neither that decision nor a waiver recorded, so the current status must remain accurate.
- 15 **Marta:** Understood. I will have our test lead assemble the C5 and C6 evidence and confirm the file location and delivery time for your review.
- 16 **Leo:** That makes the ⁸ _____ actionable. Please confirm the sender, criterion identifiers, tested version, and when the reviewer can access the package, rather than sending another general completion message.
- 17 **Marta:** Our commercial team may ask what this means for invoicing. I should not infer a payment rule from the technical acceptance discussion alone.
- 18 **Leo:** Refer that to the ⁹ _____ and the governing terms. I am describing the evidence and acceptance status, not inventing a contractual payment outcome.
- 19 **Marta:** I will update our status to development complete, with client evidence review outstanding for C5 and C6. That should explain why the records currently differ.
- 20 **Leo:** Good. The ¹⁰ _____ can be completed when the applicable review and decision occur. For now: four verified criteria, two awaiting evidence, and no acceptance or exception yet recorded.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. completion claim | 2. evidence gap | 3. statement of work | 4. requirements matrix | 5. actual result | 6. waiver | 7. conditional acceptance | 8. evidence handoff | 9. contract owner | 10. acceptance record

Unverified does not mean failed

F Say it

Five criteria are agreed. Evidence supports four; the fifth has not been reviewed because its result is missing. No waiver or acceptance is recorded.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unverified / evidence / recorded / failure

Client: "Four criteria have supporting ¹ _____."

Vendor: "The fifth remains ² _____."

Client: "That does not itself prove a ³ _____."

Vendor: "No acceptance has been ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. evidence | 2. unverified | 3. failure | 4. recorded

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Turn communication was poor into a testable action

A Read the situation

Convert a vague lesson into a specific process change with an owner, deadline, adoption check, and separate effectiveness review.

Review facilitator Hana and project-office lead Sanjay examine five scope handoffs from a completed project. Three lack recorded recipient acknowledgment before work began, and two tasks were reworked using an older specification. The notes repeatedly say communication was poor but contain no improvement action. The record does not prove a single cause. Sanjay proposes a revised handoff record by October 10 and a check of the next five handoffs. No pilot result is available yet.

PEOPLE / Hana: Review facilitator | Sanjay: Project-office lead

08

A LESSON NEEDS SOMEWHERE TO GO

A review can sound candid while leaving the next project unchanged. Name the observed process gap and a concrete improvement, then distinguish whether people adopt the new process from whether it improves the outcome. Keep accountability without inventing a single culprit or a causal conclusion the record cannot support.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many reviewed handoffs lacked recorded acknowledgment before work?

A All five

B Two of ten

C None

D Three of five

2. What is established about the rework?

A Two tasks used an older specification and were reworked.

B All rework was proven to have a single cause.

C The pilot eliminated every future error.

D No specification version was ever involved.

3. What is the status of the proposed improvement?

A Proposed, with no pilot result yet

B Already proven effective over many projects

C Fully adopted in the next five handoffs

D A completed organization-wide policy audit

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

post-implementation review

An assessment after delivery of results, process, and lessons.

IN USE conduct a post-implementation review

after-action review

A structured discussion of what happened and what to improve.

IN USE facilitate an after-action review

lessons log

A record of learning from project experience.

IN USE maintain the lessons log

actionable lesson

Learning translated into a specific usable change.

IN USE formulate an actionable lesson

contributing factor

A condition that may have helped produce an outcome.

IN USE investigate a contributing factor

root-cause hypothesis

A proposed explanation for an underlying cause that needs evidence.

IN USE test a root-cause hypothesis

causal claim

A statement that one factor produced an outcome.

IN USE qualify a causal claim

blameless review

A learning-focused review that avoids unsupported personal blame without removing accountability.

IN USE hold a blameless review

knowledge transfer

Passing usable information or experience to another team.

IN USE improve knowledge transfer

improvement backlog

A prioritized list of changes intended to improve future work.

IN USE maintain an improvement backlog

corrective action

An action addressing a detected problem or its causes under the stated process.

IN USE assign a corrective action

preventive action

An action intended to reduce the chance of a future problem.

IN USE define a preventive action

Precision check

Two of five handoffs had recorded acknowledgment, a 40% baseline on that process measure. A future four of five would be 80%, an increase of 40 percentage points. It would still miss a five-of-five target and would not alone prove less rework.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

process owner

The person accountable for a defined working process.

IN USE identify the process owner

due date

The agreed date by which a task should be completed.

IN USE set the due date

adoption check

A check that the intended process is actually being used.

IN USE perform an adoption check

effectiveness review

An assessment of whether the change achieves its intended effect.

IN USE conduct an effectiveness review

process measure

An indicator of how work is performed.

IN USE define a process measure

outcome measure

An indicator of the result produced by the work.

IN USE distinguish an outcome measure

baseline value

The reference measurement before the assessed change.

IN USE establish the baseline value

comparison window

The defined period or cases used for comparison.

IN USE specify the comparison window

sample size

The number of observations in an assessment.

IN USE state the sample size

version reference

The identifier of the document or specification used.

IN USE confirm the version reference

recipient acknowledgment

Confirmation from the receiving person that the specified handoff was received.

IN USE obtain recipient acknowledgment

closure criterion

The condition required to mark an improvement action complete.

IN USE define the closure criterion

Precision check

No pilot result is supplied in the main case. The revised record, its use, and its effectiveness are separate checks. A small before-and-after sample can reveal a process change without establishing that it alone caused an outcome difference.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

REPLACE THE VAGUE LABEL

"Three of five handoffs lacked recorded acknowledgment before work began."

LIMIT THE CAUSAL CLAIM

"The record does not establish one exclusive cause."

ASSIGN THE OWNER

"Sanjay will prepare the revised record by October 10."

STATE THE PROCESS TARGET

"Each of the five should have the required record before work starts."

STATE THE LINKED OBSERVATION

"Two tasks were reworked using an older specification."

NAME A CONCRETE CHANGE

"Add the scope identifier, version, owner, and recipient acknowledgment to the handoff record."

DEFINE THE PILOT

"Check the next five scope handoffs."

SEPARATE IMPLEMENTATION

"Publishing the template does not show that teams use it."

08

Poor

Too broad to identify a repeatable improvement by itself.

Cause

Needs evidence stronger than a nearby event or plausible story.

Published

A document exists; it may not yet be used.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK ADOPTION

"Review the actual handoff records, not just training attendance."

KEEP THE SAMPLE VISIBLE

"Five cases are a small review sample, not universal proof."

PRESERVE INCOMPLETE STATUS

"Four of five would show improvement but miss the five-of-five target."

CLOSE WITH EVIDENCE

"Mark the action complete only against its defined closure criterion."

MEASURE THE OUTCOME SEPARATELY

"Track version-related rework on a stated comparison basis."

AVOID PERCENTAGE CONFUSION

"Moving from 40% to 80% is a 40-percentage-point increase."

PLAN THE EFFECTIVENESS REVIEW

"Set who will check whether the change reduces the intended problem."

TRANSFER THE LEARNING

"Put the tested change where the next project will actually use it."

08

Adopted

People use the process; the desired outcome still needs checking.

Effective

Specify the outcome, evidence, and comparison.

Learned

A recorded lesson becomes useful when it changes relevant future work.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which action is most specific?

- A** All teams should try harder without a review date.
- B** The same vague lesson should be copied into every future report.
- C** Sanjay revises the handoff record by October 10 and checks required fields in the next five handoffs.
- D** Everyone should communicate better somehow.

2. Why does a published template not prove effectiveness?

- A** A template makes outcome measurement impossible.
- B** Publication proves a single root cause retrospectively.
- C** Existence, use, and effect are different questions.
- D** Every published document automatically prevents mistakes.

3. A later pilot records acknowledgment in four of five handoffs. What is the process result?

- A** 40%, exactly the baseline
- B** 100%, because four is close to five
- C** Proof that all future rework is eliminated
- D** 80%, above the 40% baseline but below the five-of-five target

4. What does a small improved before-and-after result establish by itself?

- A** A reason to remove the sample size from reporting
- B** An observed difference in the measured cases, not proof of an exclusive cause
- C** A universal guarantee for every future project
- D** Proof that no other factor changed

Answers and explanations: page 90.

Turn communication was poor into a testable action

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

recipient acknowledgment / process owner / sample size / causal claim / baseline value / closure criterion / process measure / version reference / adoption check / effectiveness review

08

- 01 **Hana:** The review notes say communication was poor three times, but I cannot find an action that would change the next project. What did the records actually show?
- 02 **Sanjay:** Three of five handoffs lacked recorded ¹ _____ before work started. We also found two tasks that used an older specification and had to be reworked.
- 03 **Hana:** Those are more useful observations than the broad label. Do they prove that the missing acknowledgment was the sole cause of the rework?
- 04 **Sanjay:** No. That would be an unsupported ² _____. The records suggest a process gap to investigate, but they do not exclude other contributing factors.
- 05 **Hana:** Let us define a change that addresses the gap without pretending the analysis is finished. What should the handoff record contain that it does not reliably show now?
- 06 **Sanjay:** Add the scope identifier, ³ _____, responsible owner, and recipient acknowledgment before work starts. That makes the transferred instruction identifiable rather than leaving the receiver to infer which document applies.
- 07 **Hana:** Who will produce the revised record, and by when? A lesson saying someone should improve the template may disappear as soon as the project closes.
- 08 **Sanjay:** I will be the ⁴ _____ and prepare the revision by October tenth. Record that commitment with the deliverable, not simply assign it to the project office.
- 09 **Hana:** Then we need to find out whether people use it. A new template in a folder can look like completion while the actual handoffs continue unchanged.
- 10 **Sanjay:** Run an ⁵ _____ on the next five scope handoffs. Check the required fields and acknowledgment before work starts, rather than counting how many people attended a briefing.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Hana:** What is the comparison point? We need a clear measure so a later reviewer can tell whether the process changed.
- 12 **Sanjay:** The ⁶ _____ is two of five with recorded acknowledgment, or forty percent. The pilot target is five of five, with the sample and timing basis stated.
- 13 **Hana:** Suppose the pilot later shows four of five. That would be progress, but the target would still be unmet, and it would not tell us everything about rework.
- 14 **Sanjay:** Correct. The ⁷ _____ would be eighty percent. That is forty percentage points above baseline, not evidence that every intended outcome has been achieved.
- 15 **Hana:** We should measure version-related rework separately. Otherwise the team may comply with the form while still using the wrong specification during the task.
- 16 **Sanjay:** Set an ⁸ _____ with a responsible reviewer and comparison window. Adoption matters, but the intended result needs its own evidence and a clear measurement basis.
- 17 **Hana:** Five cases is also a small sample. We can use it to spot a problem with the process, but not claim a universal result from a short pilot.
- 18 **Sanjay:** State the ⁹ _____ whenever reporting the result. Keep other possible influences visible instead of treating a before-and-after difference as proof that our change was the only cause.
- 19 **Hana:** That gives us an action, an owner, a deadline, and two different checks: whether the process is used and whether it helps. How should we close it?
- 20 **Sanjay:** Define the ¹⁰ _____ for each stage. We should not mark the entire lesson resolved merely because the template was published; the follow-up records must show what was implemented and what was actually learned.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. recipient acknowledgment | 2. causal claim | 3. version reference | 4. process owner | 5. adoption check | 6. baseline value | 7. process measure | 8. effectiveness review | 9. sample size | 10. closure criterion

A better rate, an unmet target

F Say it

The baseline has recorded acknowledgment in three of six handoffs. A later pilot has five of six, against a six-of-six target. Rework outcomes have not yet been measured.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

measured / unmet / five / fifty

08

Reviewer: "The baseline rate was ¹ _____ percent."

Owner: "The pilot has ² _____ acknowledged handoffs out of six."

Reviewer: "The six-of-six target remains ³ _____."

Owner: "Rework effectiveness is not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. fifty | 2. five | 3. unmet | 4. measured

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Project Charter and Scope Definition

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Who are the proposed first-release users?

C. Operations leads doing weekly queue triage

The meeting proposal identifies operations leads and their weekly triage task.

2. Which feature is proposed as excluded?

A. Automated work allocation

The proposed boundary explicitly excludes automated allocation while retaining visibility and export.

3. What does four weeks represent now?

B. A requested target, not a supported delivery commitment

The request precedes confirmed access, acceptance criteria, and an approved scope baseline.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which scope statement best matches the supplied proposal?

D. Overdue-item visibility and export for weekly operations triage, excluding automated allocation

This wording identifies the intended users, work purpose, included functions, and explicit exclusion.

2. What can Elena responsibly say about four weeks?

D. It is the target; access, acceptance, and feasibility still need confirmation.

The missing planning inputs prevent the requested date from becoming a supported commitment.

3. Which is an outcome rather than merely an output?

C. Operations leads make better-supported queue-priority decisions.

An outcome concerns changed use or behavior enabled by the delivered outputs.

4. Why define who accepts the work?

B. A useful demonstration does not identify authorized acceptance by itself.

Acceptance requires an applicable decision process and authority, not simply a favorable reaction.

01 Conversation answers

Project Charter and Scope Definition

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. business need.** Turn 2. The business need explains the problem the dashboard addresses rather than assuming its form defines its purpose.
- 2. end user.** Turn 4. The end user is the operations lead using the proposed dashboard for weekly triage.
- 3. out of scope.** Turn 6. Out of scope identifies automated allocation as excluded from the proposed first release.
- 4. deliverable.** Turn 8. The deliverable is the dashboard output, distinct from the operational result achieved by using it.
- 5. acceptance criterion.** Turn 10. An acceptance criterion makes adequacy checkable instead of relying on a favorable demonstration impression.
- 6. assumption.** Turn 12. The assumption is the unverified planning premise that the source data will be available.
- 7. constraint.** Turn 14. The requested timing is a planning limit to assess, not evidence that the proposed work is feasible within it.
- 8. scope statement.** Turn 16. The scope statement describes the proposed work and boundaries before they become an approved reference.
- 9. requirements traceability.** Turn 18. Requirements traceability connects each requirement and its evidence to the underlying need and agreed work.
- 10. scope approval.** Turn 20. Scope approval authorizes the defined boundaries; the current discussion prepares that decision rather than pretending it occurred.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. export

Sponsor: "The included capability is a weekly export."

The supplied proposal specifically includes an export for the first release.

2. excluded

Manager: "Automated allocation is excluded."

The proposed boundary explicitly leaves automated allocation outside this release.

3. unconfirmed

Sponsor: "Data access remains unconfirmed."

The briefing does not establish that the source data is available.

4. commitment

Manager: "The target is not an approved commitment."

The requested date has not received approval as a delivery commitment.

02 Briefing and language checks

Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. How late is the testing finish forecast?

C. Three working days

The forecast moves from the end of working day 5 to the end of working day 8.

2. When did the baseline release chain finish?

A. End of day 8

Testing ended on day 5, rehearsal used days 6 and 7, and approval used day 8.

3. What is the forecast release finish with unchanged logic and durations?

A. End of day 11

Testing ends on day 8, rehearsal uses days 9 and 10, and approval uses day 11.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which statement correctly reports the unchanged forecast?

D. Release moves from end of day 8 to end of day 11, a three-working-day delay.

The sequential two-day rehearsal and one-day approval preserve the three-day shift in the controlling chain.

2. What does the on-time status of unrelated work establish?

C. That work is on schedule, not that this critical chain is unaffected

Independent progress does not remove the stated dependency that controls the release.

3. Which proposal is fast-tracking?

D. Overlap tasks previously planned in sequence, after assessing feasibility and risk

Fast-tracking changes sequencing through overlap and can introduce additional risk.

4. A different task has four days of total float and slips three days with no other changes. What follows?

A. Its slip can be absorbed without moving the defined project finish.

The three-day movement is within the stated four-day allowance under that different schedule model.

02 Conversation answers

02

Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. critical path.** Turn 2. The critical path is the stated controlling testing-rehearsal-approval chain, so independent on-time work does not remove its delay.
- 2. schedule baseline.** Turn 4. The schedule baseline puts testing at day 5, rehearsal on days 6-7, and approval on day 8.
- 3. finish-to-start dependency.** Turn 6. A finish-to-start dependency prevents rehearsal from starting until testing has finished under the stated plan.
- 4. downstream impact.** Turn 8. The downstream impact is the three-day movement of the subsequent chain, not repeated addition of the same delay.
- 5. working calendar.** Turn 10. The working calendar defines available workdays and must be consistent across the baseline and forecast calculation.
- 6. total float.** Turn 12. Total float is schedule flexibility before the defined finish moves; this controlling chain is stated to have none.
- 7. crashing.** Turn 14. Crashing adds resources or cost to shorten duration only where the activity can actually use them effectively.
- 8. fast-tracking.** Turn 16. Fast-tracking overlaps previously sequential work and requires assessment of feasibility and additional risk.
- 9. schedule forecast.** Turn 18. The schedule forecast is the current timing estimate; updating it does not silently authorize a new baseline.
- 10. forecast variance.** Turn 20. Forecast variance is the difference between current forecast and the original reference, here three working days.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. five

Planner: "The original chain finished on day five."

Testing through day four followed by one review day finishes on day five.

2. seven

Lead: "The forecast finish is now day seven."

Testing through day six followed by one review day finishes on day seven.

3. two

Planner: "That is a two-working-day delay."

The finish moves from day five to day seven, a two-day difference.

4. approved

Lead: "No recovery has been approved."

The briefing explicitly leaves every recovery option without authorization.

03 Briefing and language checks

Risk Register and Issue Escalation

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What has the supplier confirmed?

A. The October 12 commitment will be missed.

The confirmed fact is the original-date miss, while the later date remains only a possibility.

2. What does October 15 represent?

D. The earliest possible date mentioned, not a commitment

The briefing explicitly qualifies October 15 as possible rather than committed.

3. Why is the October 13 test exposed?

D. It requires the delivery that will miss October 12.

The supplied dependency connects the missed delivery to the planned test start.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which opening is accurate now?

D. The October 12 miss is confirmed; the replacement date remains uncommitted.

The opening separates the established miss from continuing uncertainty about replacement timing.

2. How should the original risk record be handled?

B. Update its status and link it to the current issue while preserving history.

Linked records preserve how the risk developed without leaving an obsolete event status in place.

3. What should an escalation request include?

C. The confirmed problem, affected objective, options, decision owner, and needed timing

Decision-useful escalation connects the facts and consequences to specific help or authorization.

4. Which is a secondary risk from using an untested replacement?

C. New quality or integration uncertainty introduced by the response

A response can create new exposure that must be distinguished from the original supplier problem.

03 Conversation answers

Risk Register and Issue Escalation

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. issue.** Turn 2. An issue is the confirmed commitment problem that now needs action, even though its final consequences remain uncertain.
- 2. response status.** Turn 4. Response status distinguishes a possible recovery date from an approved or completed response.
- 3. impact.** Turn 6. Impact concerns the effect on the planned test and project objectives, which still needs assessment beyond the confirmed miss.
- 4. risk register.** Turn 8. The risk register should preserve the original risk's history and link it to the current issue.
- 5. trigger.** Turn 10. The trigger is the confirmed supplier miss that prompts the previously identified escalation response.
- 6. action owner.** Turn 12. The action owner is responsible for the specific task of obtaining and reporting the supplier recovery information.
- 7. contingency plan.** Turn 14. A contingency plan is a prepared response whose conditions and readiness must be checked before it is treated as active.
- 8. secondary risks.** Turn 16. Secondary risks are new uncertainties introduced by the response, such as quality or integration exposure from switching suppliers.
- 9. escalation brief.** Turn 18. An escalation brief connects the confirmed problem and consequences to the specific decision or support needed.
- 10. closure evidence.** Turn 20. Closure evidence demonstrates that the defined issue-resolution conditions are met, not merely that a supplier sent a reassuring message.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. confirmed

Manager: "Tuesday's miss is confirmed."

The vendor explicitly states it cannot meet the Tuesday commitment.

2. uncommitted

Buyer: "Thursday remains uncommitted."

The later date is only suggested, with no delivery commitment.

3. dependency

Manager: "The Wednesday test has a delivery dependency."

The test requires the item, linking its timing to the vendor delivery.

4. approved

Buyer: "No alternative has been approved."

The scenario supplies no authorized substitute or recovery arrangement.

04 Briefing and language checks

Stakeholder Alignment and Governance

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. Who holds the stated change authority?

B. The sponsor

The governance plan explicitly reserves this change decision to the sponsor.

2. What did the steering group actually do?

D. Recommend a change

The brief describes a recommendation and says no sponsor decision or delegation is recorded.

3. What may the group commission under the supplied remit?

D. Analysis of the proposal

The group can recommend and request analysis, which is distinct from authorizing implementation.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which correction belongs in the minutes?

B. Change recommended; sponsor approval pending; analysis commissioned

The correction separates the actual recommendation and permitted analysis from missing approval.

2. What does the group's consensus establish?

D. Support for a recommendation within its remit

Agreement among participants does not override the authority specified by the governance plan.

3. Which task can proceed under the supplied facts?

D. Preparing the commissioned impact analysis

Commissioned analysis is within the group's stated remit, unlike the reserved change approval.

4. Which record best captures conditional approval if it is later given?

A. The actual approver, permitted change, explicit conditions, and condition status

The conditions define the approval's scope and must not disappear during the handoff.

04 Conversation answers

Stakeholder Alignment and Governance

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. recommendation. Turn 2. A recommendation proposes a course of action; it does not establish the reserved sponsor approval.

2. quorum. Turn 4. A quorum satisfies the group's participation rules but does not expand its substantive decision authority.

3. terms of reference. Turn 6. Terms of reference define the steering group's remit, here recommendation and analysis rather than reserved change approval.

4. delegated authority. Turn 8. Delegated authority must be explicitly established; the team cannot infer it from a possible undocumented arrangement.

5. action log. Turn 10. The action log records the authorized assessment task, its owner, and deadline, not a decision to implement.

6. decision paper. Turn 12. A decision paper presents the options, consequences, and specific authorization requested from the proper decision maker.

7. authorization. Turn 14. Authorization identifies exactly which action is permitted; here analysis can proceed while implementation remains unapproved.

8. dissent. Turn 16. Dissent preserves relevant disagreement instead of falsely presenting the recommendation as unanimous or unqualified.

9. conditional approval. Turn 18. Conditional approval permits only the stated action under explicit conditions, whose status must remain visible.

10. decision log. Turn 20. The decision log should reflect actual decisions and their authority, not convert the meeting recommendation into approval.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. recommendation

Chair: "The committee has made a recommendation."

The committee supports an option without holding the reserved approval authority.

2. assessment

Manager: "The authorized next task is the assessment."

The committee can commission the analysis requested in the briefing.

3. pending

Chair: "The sponsor's decision is still pending."

The finance sponsor has not made the required decision.

4. authorized

Manager: "Implementation is not yet authorized."

A recommendation and an assessment request do not approve the cost change.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Change Requests and Scope Creep

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. How much effort is estimated for the new report?

B. Four person-days including testing

The brief gives a four-person-day estimate and explicitly includes testing.

2. Which assessed option retains the launch date?

B. Defer the existing four-person-day export feature

The assessed substitution frees the effort needed for the new report while retaining the date.

3. What is the status of both options?

B. They need approval.

The briefing states that neither option has yet received authorization.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which response is both constructive and accurate?

A. We can assess the new value through the two stated options, each with a consequence and approval need.

The response acknowledges the request while preserving capacity, trade-offs, and decision authority.

2. Why does the four-person-day estimate not mean a four-day extension here?

B. Effort and elapsed duration differ; the assessed team plan gives two working days.

The supplied assessment distinguishes total work from elapsed schedule time with the planned resources.

3. What must the date-preserving option disclose?

D. The existing export will be deferred from this release.

The option preserves time by changing scope, so the removed capability must remain explicit.

4. What turns an addition into uncontrolled scope creep?

A. Implementing extra work without the required assessment and authorization

Controlled changes can be legitimate; uncontrolled expansion bypasses the project's stated decision process.

05 Conversation answers

Change Requests and Scope Creep

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

- 1. change request.** Turn 2. A change request captures the proposed new report so its effort, impacts, and approval can be assessed.
- 2. effort estimate.** Turn 4. The effort estimate is four person-days and explicitly includes testing rather than counting only construction.
- 3. scope substitution.** Turn 6. Scope substitution replaces the existing four-person-day export feature with the new report under an approved change.
- 4. benefit impact.** Turn 8. Benefit impact concerns the value affected when the planned export is deferred, even though the launch date is retained.
- 5. elapsed duration.** Turn 10. Elapsed duration is the schedule time; this option extends it by two working days, distinct from four person-days of effort.
- 6. test coverage.** Turn 12. Test coverage remains within the assessed work; silently dropping required checks is not one of the options.
- 7. option comparison.** Turn 14. The option comparison presents both alternatives on a common scope, time, and assumption basis.
- 8. approval record.** Turn 16. The approval record must reflect the actual decision; no option has been authorized in this conversation.
- 9. decision latency.** Turn 18. Decision latency is the time taken to receive the needed choice, which can change the feasibility of the assessed options.
- 10. baseline revision.** Turn 20. A baseline revision updates the controlled plan after approval and communicates the selected scope and timing.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. effort

Sponsor: "The new feature requires three person-days of effort."

Person-days measure the estimated work, not an automatic number of elapsed days.

2. substitution

Manager: "Keeping the date requires the assessed scope substitution."

The stated option replaces one feature with another to release capacity.

3. deferred

Sponsor: "The original feature would be deferred."

The date-preserving option removes that feature from the current delivery.

4. approval

Manager: "The option still needs approval."

The briefing says no option is authorized, so implementation cannot be assumed.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Status Reporting and Executive Updates

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What does eight of ten establish?

B. Eighty percent of the task count is complete.

The brief supplies an unweighted task count, not effort weighting or complete delivery evidence.

2. Why does the access approval matter?

C. It is needed for the rehearsal that precedes launch.

The stated chain links access due October 9 to rehearsal and the planned launch.

3. Which rating matches the supplied rules and facts?

C. Amber

The rules require amber for a material threat needing management attention, which the open dependency creates.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which executive summary is best supported?

A. Amber: access due October 9 is unconfirmed; rehearsal and launch are exposed; owner and decision follow-up needed.

This summary follows the stated criteria and names the material dependency without inventing a final delay.

2. Why is "80% of the project is done" too broad?

D. Only unweighted task counts are supplied.

Task-count completion does not establish weighted effort, value, or the importance of remaining work.

3. What would be needed to calculate CPI?

B. Earned value and actual cost on a defined basis

CPI is earned value divided by actual cost, neither of which the task-count briefing supplies.

4. Which wording preserves uncertainty accurately?

B. October 16 remains planned, but the unconfirmed dependency creates a material threat.

The wording distinguishes the planned date from confidence in meeting it.

06 Conversation answers

Status Reporting and Executive Updates

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. RAG rating.** Turn 2. The RAG rating must follow the stated criteria, including material threats, rather than simply count completed tasks.
- 2. task-count completion.** Turn 4. Task-count completion is eight finished tasks out of ten, without weighting their size or importance.
- 3. dependency due date.** Turn 6. The dependency due date is October 9, when approval is needed to support the planned rehearsal.
- 4. confidence qualifier.** Turn 8. A confidence qualifier distinguishes the planned date from the uncertainty created by the unresolved dependency.
- 5. dependency owner.** Turn 10. The dependency owner is accountable for managing the required access input and its follow-up.
- 6. executive ask.** Turn 12. The executive ask requests support for a timely authorized decision, not permission to bypass the required control.
- 7. Earned value.** Turn 14. Earned value measures budgeted completed work under a defined method; unweighted task counts do not provide it.
- 8. exception report.** Turn 16. An exception report focuses attention on the condition needing action while preserving its relevant progress context.
- 9. Delivery confidence.** Turn 18. Delivery confidence concerns the remaining path to the intended outcome, not merely how many historical tasks are complete.
- 10. status date.** Turn 20. The status date identifies when the report's facts and outlook apply, making later changes traceable.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. seventy-five

Lead: "Task-count completion is seventy-five percent."

Six divided by eight equals seventy-five percent of the listed task count.

2. progress

Sponsor: "That does not establish weighted progress."

No effort or value weights are supplied for the eight tasks.

3. amber

Lead: "Under our rules, the rating is amber."

The stated local rules assign amber to the material unresolved dependency.

4. confirmed

Sponsor: "A final delay is not yet confirmed."

The briefing identifies a threat without establishing a final delay.

06

07 Briefing and language checks

Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. How many criteria currently have verified evidence?

C. Four of six

Leo can verify four criteria; C5 and C6 lack evidence in the current record.

2. What follows from missing evidence for C5 and C6?

C. Their compliance has not yet been demonstrated in the record.

Missing proof leaves acceptance unresolved without establishing that the underlying functions fail.

3. Who may waive the criteria under the supplied facts?

A. The appropriate authority, which Leo cannot replace alone

The brief explicitly says Leo cannot waive the criteria alone and records no waiver.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which response preserves both accuracy and scope?

A. Please supply evidence for the existing C5 and C6 criteria; we are not adding new requirements.

The response requests the missing proof against the agreed scope without inventing failure or extra work.

2. What should an evidence package make traceable?

A. Criterion, tested version, context, and actual result against expectation

Identifiable test context and results allow the reviewer to assess the actual agreed criterion.

3. Which acceptance status is supported now?

A. No acceptance or waiver is recorded.

The brief explicitly leaves acceptance and waiver absent and limits Leo's authority.

4. What should be said about payment consequences?

A. They need assessment against the agreement by the appropriate owner.

The supplied facts do not establish the contractual payment rules or authorize a commercial conclusion.

07 Conversation answers

Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. completion claim. Turn 2. A completion claim is the vendor's statement of finished work, distinct from the client's acceptance evidence.

2. evidence gap. Turn 4. An evidence gap means the supporting information is missing, not that the function has been proven defective.

3. statement of work. Turn 6. The statement of work and agreed criteria define the original delivery scope, not new requirements invented during acceptance.

4. requirements matrix. Turn 8. The requirements matrix connects each criterion identifier with the relevant version, status, and supporting result.

5. actual result. Turn 10. The actual result is the recorded behavior observed in the identified test, to be compared with the expected result.

6. waiver. Turn 12. A waiver is an authorized exception; Leo does not have unilateral authority to remove the two criteria.

7. conditional acceptance. Turn 14. Conditional acceptance needs the relevant authority and explicit conditions; it is not established by discussing the option.

8. evidence handoff. Turn 16. The evidence handoff specifies who sends the missing results, where they are available, and when review can occur.

9. contract owner. Turn 18. The contract owner must assess commercial consequences against the governing agreement rather than a generic completion label.

10. acceptance record. Turn 20. The acceptance record should capture the actual authorized decision after evidence review, not convert delivery status into acceptance.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. evidence

Client: "Four criteria have supporting evidence."

The briefing says four of the five criteria have demonstrated support.

2. unverified

Vendor: "The fifth remains unverified."

Its result is missing, so compliance has not yet been demonstrated.

3. failure

Client: "That does not itself prove a failure."

Missing information is not evidence that the underlying function failed.

4. recorded

Vendor: "No acceptance has been recorded."

The supplied facts explicitly leave the acceptance record absent.

08 Briefing and language checks

Post-Implementation Review

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. How many reviewed handoffs lacked recorded acknowledgment before work?

D. Three of five

The briefing identifies three missing acknowledgments among five examined handoffs.

2. What is established about the rework?

A. Two tasks used an older specification and were reworked.

The record describes two reworked tasks but does not establish a complete causal explanation.

3. What is the status of the proposed improvement?

A. Proposed, with no pilot result yet

The briefing supplies a proposed action and review plan, not results.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which action is most specific?

C. Sanjay revises the handoff record by October 10 and checks required fields in the next five handoffs.

The action identifies an owner, deliverable, deadline, and observable follow-up sample.

2. Why does a published template not prove effectiveness?

C. Existence, use, and effect are different questions.

The team must examine adoption and outcomes separately from the creation of the document.

3. A later pilot records acknowledgment in four of five handoffs. What is the process result?

D. 80%, above the 40% baseline but below the five-of-five target

Four divided by five is 80%; it improves the observed rate without meeting the full target.

4. What does a small improved before-and-after result establish by itself?

B. An observed difference in the measured cases, not proof of an exclusive cause

A small comparison can show a change without isolating causality or supporting a universal guarantee.

08 Conversation answers

Post-Implementation Review

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. recipient acknowledgment.** Turn 2. Recipient acknowledgment is the receiving person's confirmation, missing before work began in three reviewed cases.
- 2. causal claim.** Turn 4. A causal claim would assert that the missing acknowledgment produced the rework, which this record does not establish exclusively.
- 3. version reference.** Turn 6. The version reference identifies which specification the receiving team is meant to use.
- 4. process owner.** Turn 8. The process owner is accountable for the defined handoff process and its proposed improvement, here Sanjay.
- 5. adoption check.** Turn 10. An adoption check examines whether the revised process appears in actual handoff records, not merely whether the template exists.
- 6. baseline value.** Turn 12. The baseline value is two acknowledged handoffs out of five, or 40%, under the defined process measure.
- 7. process measure.** Turn 14. The process measure tracks recorded acknowledgment, which is distinct from an outcome such as less version-related rework.
- 8. effectiveness review.** Turn 16. An effectiveness review tests whether the adopted change improves the intended result rather than stopping at procedural compliance.
- 9. sample size.** Turn 18. Sample size is the number of observed handoffs and limits the strength of broader conclusions.
- 10. closure criterion.** Turn 20. The closure criterion specifies the evidence required to complete the improvement action, keeping implementation and effectiveness distinct.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. fifty

Reviewer: "The baseline rate was fifty percent."

Three acknowledged handoffs divided by six gives a fifty-percent baseline.

2. five

Owner: "The pilot has five acknowledged handoffs out of six."

The supplied pilot result records acknowledgment in five of the six cases.

3. unmet

Reviewer: "The six-of-six target remains unmet."

One pilot handoff still lacks acknowledgment, so the stated target was not achieved.

4. measured

Owner: "Rework effectiveness is not yet measured."

The briefing explicitly leaves rework outcomes without measurement.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Project Charter and Scope Definition

Clarify the need: Which decision should the dashboard help users make?

Define the output: The first release would show overdue items and provide an export.

Identify a dependency: We still need to confirm access to the source data.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies

Start with the movement: Testing is forecast to finish three working days late.

Explain the sequence: Two days of rehearsal are followed by one day of approval.

Avoid false averaging: On-time work elsewhere does not cancel this controlling delay.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Risk Register and Issue Escalation

State the confirmed event: The supplier has confirmed it will miss October 12.

Qualify the earliest date: October 15 is the earliest possibility mentioned.

Name the owner: Assign responsibility for obtaining a committed supplier recovery plan.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Stakeholder Alignment and Governance

Check the record: The minutes say approved, but the group made a recommendation.

Separate agreement: Consensus here does not by itself provide implementation authority.

Preserve dissent: Record material objections accurately rather than inventing unanimity.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Change Requests and Scope Creep

Acknowledge the value: I understand why the new report would be useful at launch.

Avoid unit confusion: Effort is four person-days; the assessed extension is two working days.

Keep assumptions visible: Neither option assumes extra staff, overtime, or reduced testing.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Status Reporting and Executive Updates

Lead with the exception: The access dependency threatens the planned launch sequence.

Qualify the percentage: That is task-count completion, not weighted effort.

Avoid unsupported certainty: The launch is not yet confirmed delayed, but the threat is material.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery

Acknowledge the claim: I understand that your team considers development complete.

Avoid a false failure: Missing evidence does not itself establish a failed function.

Separate the statuses: Delivered is not the same as formally accepted.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Post-Implementation Review

Replace the vague label: Three of five handoffs lacked recorded acknowledgment before work began.

Name a concrete change: Add the scope identifier, version, owner, and recipient acknowledgment to the handoff record.

Separate implementation: Publishing the template does not show that teams use it.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance authority	identify the acceptance authority	59
acceptance criterion	define acceptance criteria	6
acceptance evidence	supply acceptance evidence	59
acceptance plan	confirm the acceptance plan	59
acceptance record	retain the acceptance record	60
accountability	assign accountability	33
action log	update the action log	33
action owner	name the action owner	23
actionable lesson	formulate an actionable lesson	68
activity duration	estimate activity duration	14
actual cost	report actual cost	51
actual result	record the actual result	59
adoption check	perform an adoption check	69
after-action review	facilitate an after-action review	68
amber status	explain amber status	50
approval record	retain the approval record	42
approval threshold	apply the approval threshold	32
assumption	record a planning assumption	6
assurance review	commission an assurance review	33
authorization	obtain authorization	32
baseline revision	record a baseline revision	42
baseline value	establish the baseline value	69
benefit	define the expected benefit	5
benefit impact	assess benefit impact	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

blameless review	hold a blameless review	68
business case	review the business case	5
business need	clarify the business need	5
capacity limit	explain the capacity limit	41
causal claim	qualify a causal claim	68
change authority	identify the change authority	32
change control	follow change control	41
change freeze	apply the change-freeze rules	42
change log	update the change log	41
change request	raise a change request	41
closure criterion	define the closure criterion	69
closure evidence	require closure evidence	24
commercial consequence	assess commercial consequences	60
comparison window	specify the comparison window	69
completion claim	verify a completion claim	60
conditional acceptance	document conditional acceptance	60
conditional approval	record conditional approval	33
confidence qualifier	add a confidence qualifier	51
consensus	establish the scope of consensus	33
constraint	identify a constraint	6
contingency plan	activate a contingency plan	24
contingency reserve	clarify contingency-reserve use	24
contract owner	consult the contract owner	60
contributing factor	investigate a contributing factor	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

corrective action	assign a corrective action	68
cost performance index	interpret the cost performance index	51
crashing	evaluate schedule crashing	15
critical path	analyze the critical path	14
decision deadline	state the decision deadline	24
decision latency	account for decision latency	42
decision log	maintain the decision log	33
decision paper	prepare a decision paper	33
decision rights	confirm decision rights	32
decision use	clarify the decision use	6
defect	log a verified defect	60
deferred feature	identify the deferred feature	41
delegated authority	verify delegated authority	32
deliverable	identify the deliverable	5
deliverable register	update the deliverable register	59
delivery confidence	assess delivery confidence	50
dependency due date	confirm the dependency due date	50
dependency owner	identify the dependency owner	50
dissent	record material dissent	33
downstream impact	trace the downstream impact	15
due date	set the due date	69
earned value	distinguish earned value	51
effectiveness review	conduct an effectiveness review	69
effort estimate	qualify the effort estimate	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

elapsed duration	distinguish elapsed duration	41
end user	consult the end user	6
endorsement	distinguish endorsement from approval	32
escalation brief	prepare an escalation brief	24
escalation route	use the escalation route	33
escalation threshold	apply the escalation threshold	24
evidence gap	identify an evidence gap	59
evidence handoff	agree the evidence handoff	60
exception report	raise an exception report	51
executive ask	state the executive ask	51
expected result	compare with the expected result	59
fallback plan	prepare a fallback plan	24
fast-tracking	assess fast-tracking	15
finish-to-start dependency	check a finish-to-start dependency	14
forecast variance	explain the forecast variance	15
formal acceptance	confirm formal acceptance	60
free float	distinguish free float	15
governance	clarify project governance	32
green status	justify green status	50
handover package	complete the handover package	60
impact	assess schedule impact	23
impact assessment	complete an impact assessment	41
implementation instruction	issue an implementation instruction	42
improvement backlog	maintain an improvement backlog	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

in scope confirm what is in scope	5
incremental cost assess incremental cost	42
issue log an issue	23
issue log update the issue log	23
key milestone report a key milestone	50
knowledge transfer improve knowledge transfer	68
lag define the lag	14
lagging indicator distinguish a lagging indicator	51
lead justify a schedule lead	14
leading indicator monitor a leading indicator	50
lessons log maintain the lessons log	68
likelihood reassess likelihood	23
milestone confirm the release milestone	15
minutes correct the minutes	33
mitigation assess mitigation	24
nonconformance document a nonconformance	60
opportunity assess an opportunity	23
opportunity cost explain the opportunity cost	42
option comparison prepare an option comparison	42
out of scope state what is out of scope	5
outcome distinguish outputs from outcomes	5
outcome measure distinguish an outcome measure	69
percent complete define percent complete	51
person-day estimate effort in person-days	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

planned value compare with planned value	51
post-implementation review conduct a post-implementation review	68
predecessor identify the predecessor	14
preventive action define a preventive action	68
process measure define a process measure	69
process owner identify the process owner	69
project charter approve the project charter	5
project objective define the project objective	5
project sponsor confirm the project sponsor	5
punch list maintain a punch list	60
quorum confirm a quorum	32
RACI clarify the RACI roles	33
RAG rating apply the RAG rating	50
recipient acknowledgment obtain recipient acknowledgment	69
recommendation record a recommendation	32
recovery option evaluate a recovery option	15
red status explain red status	50
release boundary clarify the release boundary	42
remaining duration update remaining duration	14
remit stay within the remit	32
reporting period define the reporting period	50
requirement clarify the requirement	6
requirements matrix review the requirements matrix	59
requirements traceability maintain requirements traceability	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

resequence assess whether to resequence work	15
residual risk monitor residual risk	24
resource leveling apply resource leveling	15
response status report response status	24
rework estimate rework	42
risk assess project risk	23
risk exposure review risk exposure	23
risk owner assign a risk owner	23
risk register maintain the risk register	23
risk response develop a risk response	24
root-cause hypothesis test a root-cause hypothesis	68
sample size state the sample size	69
schedule baseline compare with the schedule baseline	14
schedule compression assess schedule compression	15
schedule forecast update the schedule forecast	14
schedule performance index interpret the schedule performance index	51
scope approval obtain scope approval	6
scope baseline establish the scope baseline	5
scope creep prevent scope creep	41
scope statement refine the scope statement	5
scope substitution assess a scope substitution	41
secondary risk identify secondary risks	24
slippage report schedule slippage	15
stage gate prepare for a stage gate	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

stakeholder identify key stakeholders	6
statement of work refer to the statement of work	59
status date state the status date	50
status report prepare a status report	50
steering group convene the steering group	32
success measure agree a success measure	6
successor assess the successor	14
task-count completion qualify task-count completion	51
terms of reference check the terms of reference	32
test coverage preserve required test coverage	42
test data specify the test data	59
test environment identify the test environment	59
test result review a test result	59
threat identify a delivery threat	23
total float assess total float	15
trade-off present the trade-off	41
trigger recognize the trigger	23
version reference confirm the version reference	69
waiver request a waiver	60
weighted progress report weighted progress	51
work breakdown structure develop the work breakdown structure	6
work package specify a work package	6
working calendar apply the working calendar	14
working day state the delay in working days	14

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] Association for Project Management. What Is Change Control?

[Open the original source](#)

Background on recording, assessing, and deciding proposed baseline changes. The trade-off cases and decisions in this book are original. Checked 30 September 2026.

[2] Piney, C. Integrated Project Risk and Issue Management. Project Management Institute, 2012.

[Open the original source](#)

A conference paper discussing risk and issue distinctions, not a claim that every organization uses an identical register or terminology. Checked 30 September 2026.

[3] UK Government Project Delivery. Government Functional Standard GovS 002: Project Delivery.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on governance, accountability, and delivery controls in UK government. The book does not impose that framework on every organization. Checked 30 September 2026.

[4] NASA. Systems Engineering Handbook, Appendix D: Requirements Verification Matrix.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on linking requirements to identifiable verification evidence. The vendor case is a fictional project discussion, not a NASA acceptance process. Checked 30 September 2026.

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